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# FOOD SECURITY MONITOR

## AFRICA FOOD TRADE AND RESILIENCE INITIATIVE



AGRA
Sustainably Growing Africa's Food Systems
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The monthly Food Security Monitor is a critical tool for stakeholders across the African agricultural landscape. This report equips policymakers, practitioners, and the wider community with vital insights to navigate challenges, prioritise interventions, and ultimately build a more food-secure future for all. This 70th edition provides an overview of the food security situation and market prices across East, Southern, and West Africa.

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## Summary

AGRA's monthly Food Security Monitor serves as a vital tool for sharing timely data with key stakeholders, supporting informed, evidence-based decisions across the agricultural sector. Below are key highlights from the June 2026 Food Security Monitor edition:

### Global Market Updates

- Global food commodity prices increased in July 2026, with the FAO Food Price Index rising by 0.6% month-on-month and 1% year-on-year, driven by higher cereal, sugar, and vegetable oil prices linked to weather-related production concerns, Black Sea export uncertainties, strong biofuel demand, and rising crude oil prices. Similarly, the International Grains Council Grains and Oilseeds Index rose by 6.0% from June and 11.6% from a year earlier, reflecting broad-based gains across major commodities, particularly wheat and soybeans, amid tightening supplies and strong demand, while rice prices remained largely stable over the last one month.
- Global fertilizer markets showed mixed trends in July 2026, with phosphate fertilizers remaining firm as DAP and MAP prices rose marginally and remained significantly above year-earlier levels, while potash prices were stable and urea prices declined sharply for a third consecutive month from their April peak, although still higher than a year ago. **Across Africa, fertilizer prices remained elevated in several countries, particularly Rwanda, Malawi, and Mozambique**, where annual increases for key products exceeded 35% and, in some cases, 50%, reflecting persistent market tightness, while Uganda and Nigeria recorded signs of price easing following earlier increases and Zambia experienced the most significant declines, indicating improving supply conditions and reduced price pressures.
- **The 2026 El Niño event is expected to become exceptionally strong and persist into early 2027, posing significant risks to global and African food security through droughts, floods, agricultural losses, and economic disruption**. The National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration (NOAA) predicts an 81% chance of a very strong El Niño developing between October and December 2026, and a 97% chance that those El Niño conditions will persist through April 2027. The event has already contributed to rainfall deficits across several regions, including East Africa, while the African Development Bank estimates it could reduce GDP in heavily affected African countries by 1-2% and generate economic losses of US$10-20 billion through crop failures, livestock losses, infrastructure damage, rising food prices, and increased migration pressures. **In East Africa, the effects of drought are already evident, particularly in Kenya's Baringo County, where prolonged dry conditions have destroyed an estimated 75% of the expected maize harvest, with losses reaching up to 80% in some lowland areas.** These substantial production losses are raising concerns over national grain availability and potential increases in food prices, prompting governments and development partners to strengthen preparedness and response measures to mitigate the anticipated impacts on food security and livelihoods.

### Food Commodity Prices Updates

- Across **Eastern Africa, staple food markets exhibited mixed trends in July 2026, reflecting improving supplies in surplus-producing countries alongside tightening conditions in deficit markets.** Maize prices declined in Tanzania (-9.2%), Uganda (-4.7%), and Rwanda (-1.2%) as harvest arrivals boosted market availability, while prices increased in South Sudan (+29.8%), Ethiopia (+9.5%), and Kenya (+3.3%) due to supply constraints and production concerns. Rice markets remained relatively stable, with prices easing in Uganda (-5.6%), Tanzania (-4.0%), and Rwanda (-1.5%), but rising marginally in Kenya (+0.3%) and South Sudan (+0.7%). Bean prices generally weakened across the region, falling sharply in Uganda (-17.2%), Tanzania (-5.6%), and Rwanda (-3.1%), although Kenya recorded modest increases of 2.4-2.9 percent amid tightening domestic supplies. Wheat markets showed divergent trends, with prices rising by 5.0 percent in Ethiopia due to tightening supplies, while declining by 1.5 percent in Kenya following improved import availability and harvest supplies. Overall, favorable harvests in Tanzania and Uganda continued to moderate regional food price pressures, while adverse weather conditions and supply constraints in Ethiopia, Kenya, and South Sudan sustained upward pressure on staple food prices.
- **Staple food markets in Southern Africa showed mixed but generally favourable trends in July 2026, supported by improved supplies following the completion of the main harvest season**. Maize prices declined in Zambia (-9.9%) and Mozambique (-1.9%) as harvest inflows boosted market availability, while Malawi recorded a 3.2 percent increase amid localized supply pressures and strong demand. Rice prices remained broadly stable, falling in Zambia (-1.1%) and Malawi (-0.5%) but increasing modestly in Mozambique (+3.5%) due to higher import and distribution costs. Bean markets also exhibited mixed movements, with prices declining in Mozambique (-6.8%) and Zambia (-2.8%) while increasing in Malawi for both beans (+5.6%) and soybeans (+5.8%), reflecting seasonal

tightening. Despite these short-term variations, prices of most staple foods remained below levels recorded six months and one year earlier, indicating improved food availability and easing market pressures across much of the region. Looking ahead, favorable post-harvest supply conditions are expected to support market stability, although forecasts of El Niño-induced dry spells pose risks to the upcoming 2026/27 season.

- **Staple food markets in West Africa remained relatively stable in July 2026, although seasonal supply tightening contributed to localized price increases, particularly for coarse grains in the Sahel.** Maize prices remained unchanged in Burkina Faso, increased by 6.3 percent in Ghana, 7.9 percent in Togo (Centrale), and by up to 28.6 percent in Niger, while declining by 4.1 percent in Nigeria and by 6.3-7.4 percent in several markets in Mali. Rice markets were generally stable, with monthly changes mostly below 5 percent, ranging from a 0.3 percent decline in Nigeria to increases of around 4.5 percent in several markets in Niger. Millet and sorghum markets recorded stronger upward pressure, particularly in Niger where millet prices increased by up to 21.7 percent and sorghum prices by up to 21.9 percent, while sorghum prices also rose by 5.8 percent in Nigeria. Despite these localized increases, prices of most staple foods remained significantly below year-earlier levels across the region, reflecting improved supplies and market availability compared to 2025. Favorable agro-climatic conditions continue to support the 2026/27 production outlook, although conflict-related disruptions and rising fuel and fertilizer costs remain important downside risks

## Food Security Updates

- **Food security conditions across East Africa remain under significant pressure**, driven by a combination of conflict, weather shocks, high food prices, limited livelihood opportunities, and constrained humanitarian assistance. Ethiopia, South Sudan, and parts of Uganda and Kenya continue to experience widespread Crisis (IPC Phase 3) outcomes, with **South Sudan facing the most severe conditions, including Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes and a risk of Famine (IPC Phase 5) in some conflict-affected areas**. Across the region, El Niño-related rainfall deficits, delayed planting, poor pasture conditions, livestock losses, and below-average crop production are undermining food availability and income generation, particularly in Ethiopia, Uganda's Karamoja region, and pastoral areas of Kenya. While improved rainfall in some areas and anticipated harvests are expected to bring localized improvements from late 2026, recovery is likely to be limited by below-average production, elevated food and fuel prices, shrinking purchasing power, and persistent insecurity. Refugee populations and internally displaced persons remain among the most vulnerable groups, with many dependent on humanitarian assistance that is increasingly constrained by funding shortfalls and access challenges. Overall, food insecurity is expected to remain elevated across much of the region through early 2027 despite pockets of seasonal improvement.
- **Food security conditions across Southern Africa are generally more favourable than in recent years** following improved harvests, but significant localized vulnerabilities remain and conditions are expected to deteriorate in several areas during the upcoming lean season. **Malawi, Zambia, and Zimbabwe are currently experiencing predominantly Minimal (IPC Phase 1) to Stressed (IPC Phase 2) outcomes**, supported by above-average or improved harvests, household food stocks, and relatively stable market supplies. However, parts of southern Malawi, western and southern Zambia, and deficit-producing areas of Zimbabwe are expected to face increasing food insecurity from October onwards as household food stocks decline, market dependence increases, and purchasing power remains constrained by elevated food, fuel, and transport costs. **In Mozambique, food security conditions remain more severe, with Crisis (IPC Phase 3) outcomes persisting in conflict-affected northern Cabo Delgado** and likely expanding in areas affected by previous weather shocks as households struggle with rising food prices, below-average incomes, and insecure livelihoods. Across the region, concerns are growing over the potential impacts of a strengthening El Niño event, which is expected to bring below-average rainfall, prolonged dry spells, and reduced agricultural labour opportunities, particularly in Mozambique and other drought-prone areas. While government grain procurement programmes, strategic food reserves, humanitarian assistance, and disaster preparedness measures are helping to support food access and market stability, household resilience remains fragile in many vulnerable areas, and food security conditions are expected to worsen for poor households through early 2027.
- Food security conditions across **West Africa** remain heavily influenced by conflict, insecurity, population displacement, and weather-related shocks, resulting in a mixed but generally fragile outlook. **Crisis (IPC Phase 3) and Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes persist in conflict-affected areas of Burkina Faso, Mali, Niger, Nigeria, and northern Togo**, where insecurity continues to disrupt agricultural production, trade, market access, livelihoods, and humanitarian operations. Although some countries are benefiting from lower cereal prices, improving harvest prospects, and localized gains in security, poor households in affected areas continue to face high food prices, reduced incomes, limited labour opportunities, and constrained access to food. Across the region, delayed and uneven rainfall has affected planting and pasture conditions, raising concerns about

agricultural performance in the 2026 season, while refugee inflows and displacement are placing additional pressure on host communities, particularly in northern Côte d'Ivoire and conflict-affected border regions. Humanitarian assistance remains critical for vulnerable populations but is increasingly challenged by funding shortfalls and access constraints. Overall, while parts of the region are expected to see seasonal improvements with upcoming harvests, food insecurity is likely to remain elevated through early 2027, particularly in areas affected by insecurity, displacement, and weak purchasing power.

## Food Trade Updates

- **Burkina Faso has lifted its four-year ban on millet, maize, and sorghum flour exports**, allowing processors to access foreign markets again while requiring special export permits to monitor export volumes and safeguard domestic food supplies. The policy change follows a 53% increase in national cereal production between 2021/22 and 2025/26 and is expected to support local processing industries, expand market opportunities, and balance food security with economic growth.
- The Nigeria Customs Service has launched a pilot Management Information System (MIS) and Electronic Cargo Tracking System (ECTS) at the PTML Area Command in Lagos to modernize customs operations, improve cargo monitoring, streamline trade processes, enhance transparency, and accelerate efficient, technology-driven border management.
- Afreximbank's Africa Trade and Distribution Company Limited (ATDC) has launched national trade and distribution platforms in Zimbabwe and Malawi through joint ventures with CBZ Agro Yield and Press Corporation Plc, respectively, to strengthen value chains, improve logistics, facilitate trade finance, and expand intra-African trade. The new platforms aim to support commodity aggregation, warehousing, exports, market access, and SME development, while addressing market fragmentation and advancing the implementation of the African Continental Free Trade Area (AfCFTA) as part of ATDC's broader African industrialisation strategy.

# Introduction

The AGRA Food Security Monitor reviews and discusses changes in selected variables and their implications for food trade, and food and nutrition security. The discussions presented here focus on selected countries of interest to AGRA: East Africa (Ethiopia, Kenya, South Sudan, Rwanda, Tanzania and Uganda), Southern Africa (Malawi, Mozambique, Zambia and Zimbabwe), and West Africa (Burkina Faso, Côte d'Ivoire, Ghana, Mali, Niger, Nigeria and Togo).

## Food Security Dashboard

The Food Security Dashboard summarises trends in the number of people experiencing IPC/CH Phase 3+ or Equivalent (**Table 2**) and tracks average changes in food prices over the past year (**Table 1**) across 17 countries in Eastern, Southern, and Western Africa.

Based on the July 2026 IPC/CH Phase 3+ estimates (**Table 2**), the overall pattern of severe food insecurity remains largely unchanged from June 2026, with most countries recording no month-on-month change. Nigeria continues to have by far the largest number of people facing Crisis or worse food insecurity, with 36.3 million people, followed by South Sudan (7.8 million), Kenya (4.1 million), Malawi (4.0 million), and Mozambique (3.5 million). At the lower end of the scale, the smallest numbers are recorded in Togo (0.33 million), Uganda (0.35 million), and Tanzania (0.51 million). In proportional terms, South Sudan remains the most severely affected country, with 55% of its population experiencing IPC/CH Phase 3+ food insecurity. This is substantially higher than all other countries in the analysis. Uganda (24%) has the second-highest proportion despite having a relatively small absolute number of affected people, followed by Kenya and Malawi (22% each). Significant population-level burdens are also observed in Mozambique (18%), Zambia (17%), Nigeria (16.7%), and Zimbabwe (16%). In contrast, Ghana (4%) records the lowest proportional burden, while Côte d'Ivoire, Tanzania, and Togo (5% each) also have relatively low shares of their populations facing Crisis or worse food insecurity.

The July data show very limited movement compared with June 2026. Most countries recorded no change, indicating persistence in food insecurity conditions. The notable exceptions are South Sudan, where the proportion declined slightly by 1%, and Uganda, where the proportion declined by 26%, suggesting an improvement in food security outcomes. Nevertheless, both countries continue to face substantial challenges, particularly South Sudan, where more than half of the population remains in IPC/CH Phase 3+. Overall, while Nigeria continues to account for the largest number of food-insecure people in absolute terms, the most severe population-wide impacts remain concentrated in South Sudan and several East and Southern African countries, where a considerably larger share of the population is experiencing Crisis or worse levels of food insecurity. The July estimates therefore reinforce the distinction between countries with large food-insecure populations due to population size, such as Nigeria, and countries with exceptionally high population-level vulnerability, such as South Sudan and Uganda.

**Table 1** presents maize price changes across selected African countries over the last six months and the last year, revealing notable regional differences. Overall, maize prices have generally declined across West Africa and parts of Southern Africa, while several East African countries continue to experience significant price increases, reflecting varying supply conditions, production outcomes, and market disruptions.

In West Africa, average maize prices largely trended downward, indicating improved market availability and easing food inflation pressures. Ghana recorded one of the steepest declines, with prices falling by 18.7% over the last six months and 50.1% year-on-year. Togo also experienced substantial reductions (-14.2%; -33.8%), while Burkina Faso saw prices decrease by 3.5% over six months and 31.8% over the year. Despite annual declines, some countries registered recent price increases, including Mali (+4.1%), Niger (+7.0%), and Nigeria (+2.6%) over the last six months, suggesting short-term tightening of supplies. However, maize prices in these countries remained considerably below year-earlier levels, falling by 20.3%, 30.8%, and 22.5%, respectively.

In East Africa, market conditions were more mixed, with several countries experiencing sustained upward price pressure. South Sudan recorded the most pronounced increases, with maize prices rising by 71.6% over the last six months and 56.0% year-on-year, highlighting severe supply constraints and ongoing market disruptions. Ethiopia also registered strong increases, with prices climbing 45.1% over six months and 49.5% over the year, suggesting persistent inflationary pressures in maize markets. By contrast, Kenya (-2.0%) and Rwanda (-5.8%) experienced modest price declines over the last six months, although prices remained higher than a year ago by 5.6% and 6.1%, respectively. Uganda recorded a 10.5% increase over six months, but prices were still 19.5% lower than a year earlier, indicating a recent recovery following earlier declines. Tanzania showed significant easing, with maize prices falling by 33.3% over

six months and 25.0% year-on-year, reflecting improved market supplies.

Southern Africa generally showed signs of easing maize prices, although conditions varied across countries. Malawi experienced substantial declines, with prices dropping 33.0% over six months and 31.3% year-on-year, while Zambia reported decreases of 31.6% and 12.3%, respectively. In contrast, Mozambique recorded one of the sharpest annual increases in the sample, with prices rising 83.5% year-on-year, despite a significant 26.0% decline over the last six months. This pattern suggests that although maize markets have recently stabilized, prices remain substantially above levels observed a year ago.

*Table 1: Changes in Average Maize Prices (Local Currency)*

| Country | Commodity Price Changes (%) in the last 6 months | | Commodity Price Changes (%) in the last 1 year | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Burkina Faso | -3.45 | ↓ | -31.84 | ↓ |
| Ethiopia | 45.13 | ↑ | 49.48 | ↑ |
| Ghana | -18.71 | ↓ | -50.14 | ↓ |
| Kenya | -1.97 | ↓ | 5.64 | ↑ |
| Malawi | -33.03 | ↓ | -31.28 | ↓ |
| Mali | 4.06 | ↑ | -20.32 | ↓ |
| Mozambique | -25.95 | ↓ | 83.49 | ↑ |
| Niger | 7.03 | ↑ | -30.75 | ↓ |
| Nigeria | 2.56 | ↑ | -22.47 | ↓ |
| Rwanda | -5.77 | ↓ | 6.11 | ↑ |
| South Sudan | 71.64 | ↑ | 56.01 | ↑ |
| Tanzania | -33.33 | ↓ | -25.00 | ↓ |
| Togo | -14.16 | ↓ | -33.78 | ↓ |
| Uganda | 10.53 | ↑ | -19.48 | ↓ |
| Zambia | -31.60 | ↓ | -12.32 | ↓ |

***Key:*** ***No Change*** ***Increase*** ***Decrease***

*Table 2: People in IPC/CH Phase 3+ or Equivalent*

| Country | IPC/CH Phase 3+ (Number) - July | IPC/CH Phase 3+ (%) - July | Change (%) from June 2026 |
|---|---|---|---|
| South Sudan | 7,834,758 | 55 | -1 |
| Uganda | 352,285 | 24 | -26 |
| Kenya | 4,118,270 | 22 | 0 |
| Malawi | 4,009,537 | 22 | 0 |
| Mozambique | 3,517,915 | 18 | 0 |
| Zambia | 1,701,303 | 17 | 0 |
| Nigeria | 36,289,939 | 16.65 | 0 |
| Zimbabwe | 2,499,000 | 16 | 0 |
| Niger | 2,420,879 | 9 | 0 |
| Mali | 1,560,189 | 6 | 0 |
| Cote d'Ivoire | 1,326,912 | 5 | 0 |
| Tanzania | 507,498 | 5 | 0 |
| Togo | 332,147 | 5 | 0 |
| Ghana | 1,502,143 | 4 | 0 |

Source: Author's construction based on WFP data

**Table 1** shows mixed cereal price (in USD) trends across monitored African markets between June and July 2026, with maize prices increasing in several countries while rice prices remained relatively stable, recording modest movements in most markets. For maize, South Sudan remained by far the most expensive market at USD 1,473/MT, representing a sharp 30% increase from June, followed by Zimbabwe (USD 819/MT), where prices remained unchanged. Among the lowest-priced maize markets were Tanzania (USD 227/MT), Ghana (USD 247/MT), Nigeria (USD 248/MT), and Burkina Faso (USD 271/MT). The largest month-on-month increase was recorded in South Sudan (+30%), followed by Ethiopia (+10%), Togo (+9%), and Niger (+8%). In contrast, maize prices declined most sharply in Mozambique (-13%), followed by Tanzania (-8%), Mali (-6%), and Uganda (-5%), while prices remained unchanged in Burundi and Zimbabwe.

For rice, Zambia continued to record the highest price at USD 2,198/MT, despite a 4% decline from June, followed by Zimbabwe (USD 2,060/MT) and Malawi (USD 1,946/MT), where prices were largely stable. Nigeria remained the lowest-priced rice market at USD 487/MT, followed by Burkina Faso (USD 648/MT) and South Sudan (USD 707/MT). The largest declines were observed in Uganda (-6%), Tanzania (-4%), Zambia (-4%), and Ghana (-3%). Meanwhile, rice prices increased modestly in several markets, including Mozambique (+4%), Togo (+2%), and South Sudan (+1%), while prices remained unchanged in Kenya, Malawi, and Zimbabwe.

*Table 1: The Prices of Maize and Rice Across All Monitored Countries (USD/MT)*

| Maize | July | June | % Increase/ decrease |
|---|---|---|---|
| Ethiopia | 414 | 378 | 10% |
| Kenya | 447 | 433 | 3% |
| Rwanda | 416 | 421 | -1% |
| Tanzania | 227 | 248 | -8% |
| Uganda | 406 | 426 | -5% |
| South Sudan | 1473 | 1135 | 30% |
| Burundi | 505 | 505 | 0% |
| Malawi | 448 | 433 | 3% |
| Mozambique | 447 | 456 | -2% |
| Zambia | 268 | 307 | -13% |
| Zimbabwe | 819 | 819 | 0% |
| Burkina (O'dougou) | 271 | 270 | 1% |
| Nigeria | 248 | 255 | -3% |
| Togo (Centrale) | 263 | 242 | 9% |
| Ghana | 247 | 241 | 3% |
| Niger (Niamey) | 263 | 243 | 8% |
| Mali (Bamako) | 263 | 278 | -6% |

| Rice | July | June | % Increase/ decrease |
|---|---|---|---|
| Kenya | 1403 | 1399 | 0% |
| Rwanda | 1348 | 1368 | -2% |
| Tanzania | 795 | 828 | -4% |
| South Sudan | 707 | 702 | 1% |
| Uganda | 964 | 1021 | -6% |
| Malawi | 1946 | 1951 | 0% |
| Mozambique | 779 | 752 | 4% |
| Zimbabwe (Epsworth) | 2060 | 2060 | 0% |
| Zambia | 2198 | 2295 | -4% |
| BF (Ouagadougou) | 648 | 644 | 1% |
| Senegal (Dakar) | 876 | 870 | 1% |
| Mali (Bamako) | 788 | 783 | 1% |
| Niger (Niamey) | 771 | 765 | 1% |
| Nigeria | 487 | 481 | 1% |
| Togo (Centrale) | 748 | 732 | 2% |
| Ghana | 953 | 980 | -3% |
| Cote d'Ivoire (Abidjan) | 1208 | 1200 | 1% |

# Global Market Update

## Global Food Commodity Price Trends

The FAO Food Price Index (FFPI) (**Figure 2**) averaged 131.1 points in July 2026, which is 0.6% increase from June and 1% increase over a year earlier. This increase is primarily due to higher cereal, sugar, and vegetable oil prices, which more than offset declines in meat and dairy products. Cereal prices rose on concerns over Black Sea export disruptions, heatwave-related crop damage in key producing countries, and hot, dry weather affecting maize production in the United States. Vegetable oil prices were supported by strong palm oil demand from Indonesia's biodiesel sector, robust soy oil demand in the United States, and higher crude oil prices. Sugar prices increased amid concerns over adverse weather conditions in Europe and Asia, as well as expectations of greater sugarcane diversion to ethanol production in Brazil. In contrast, meat prices declined because of ample export supplies, weak global demand, and increased market competition, while dairy prices fell due to abundant exportable supplies, subdued import demand, particularly from China, and improved availability of milk fat and dairy products in major exporting regions.[1]

As of 31st July, the International Grains Council (IGC) Grains and Oilseeds Index (GOI) (**Table 3**) stood at 237.6, increasing by 6.0% month-on-month and 11.6% year-on-year, indicating a broad surge in global grain and oilseed prices. The rise in the overall index reflects sustained upward price pressure across most major commodities, supported by strong demand and/or tightening supply conditions. Among the major commodities, wheat recorded the strongest monthly increase, rising by 9.0% and 13.4% year-on-year, highlighting significant surge in global wheat prices compared to both the previous month and the same period last year. Soybeans also posted a notable surge, increasing by 7.5% over the month and 16.7% year-on-year, the largest annual increase among the commodities tracked, underscoring continued strength in oilseed markets. Maize prices rose by 3.4% month-on-month and 2.3% year-on-year, reflecting more moderate surge relative to other commodities. Barley also surged, increasing by 2.1% during the month and 5.7% compared with a year earlier, indicating steady market support. Meanwhile, rice prices remained unchanged on a monthly basis but were 5.2% higher year-on-year, suggesting relative stability in the short term while maintaining gains over the longer term.

*Figure 2: FAO Food Price Index (FFPI)[2]*

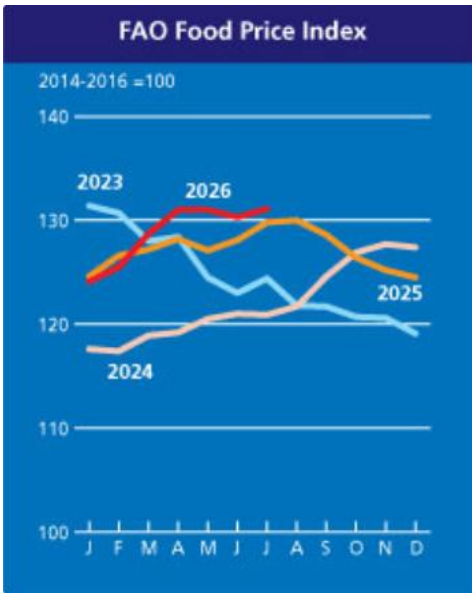



*Table 3: IGC GOI Commodity Price Indices[3]*

| Jan 2000 = 100 | 31-Jul | % Change 1M | % Change 1Y |
|---|---|---|---|
| **GOI** | 237.59 | *5.98* | *11.62* |
| **Wheat** | 219.36 | *9.03* | *13.44* |
| **Maize** | 228.67 | *3.35* | *2.26* |
| **Rice** | 175.65 | - | *5.24* |
| **Soyabeans** | 239.04 | *7.52* | *16.74* |
| **Barley** | 236.12 | *2.12* | *5.67* |

## Fertiliser Prices Outlook

Global fertilizer prices displayed mixed trends as at July 2026 end, with phosphate fertilizers remaining relatively strong while urea experienced a notable decline over the previous month (**Figure 3**). DAP prices stood at US$913/MT, increasing marginally by 0.3% month-on-month and remaining 12.6% higher year-on-year, reflecting sustained strength in phosphate markets despite recent price stabilization. Similarly, MAP prices rose to US$958/MT, recording a

[1] https://www.fao.org/worldfoodsituation/foodpricesindex/en/
[2] Ibid
[3] https://www.igc.int/en/markets/marketinfo-goi.aspx

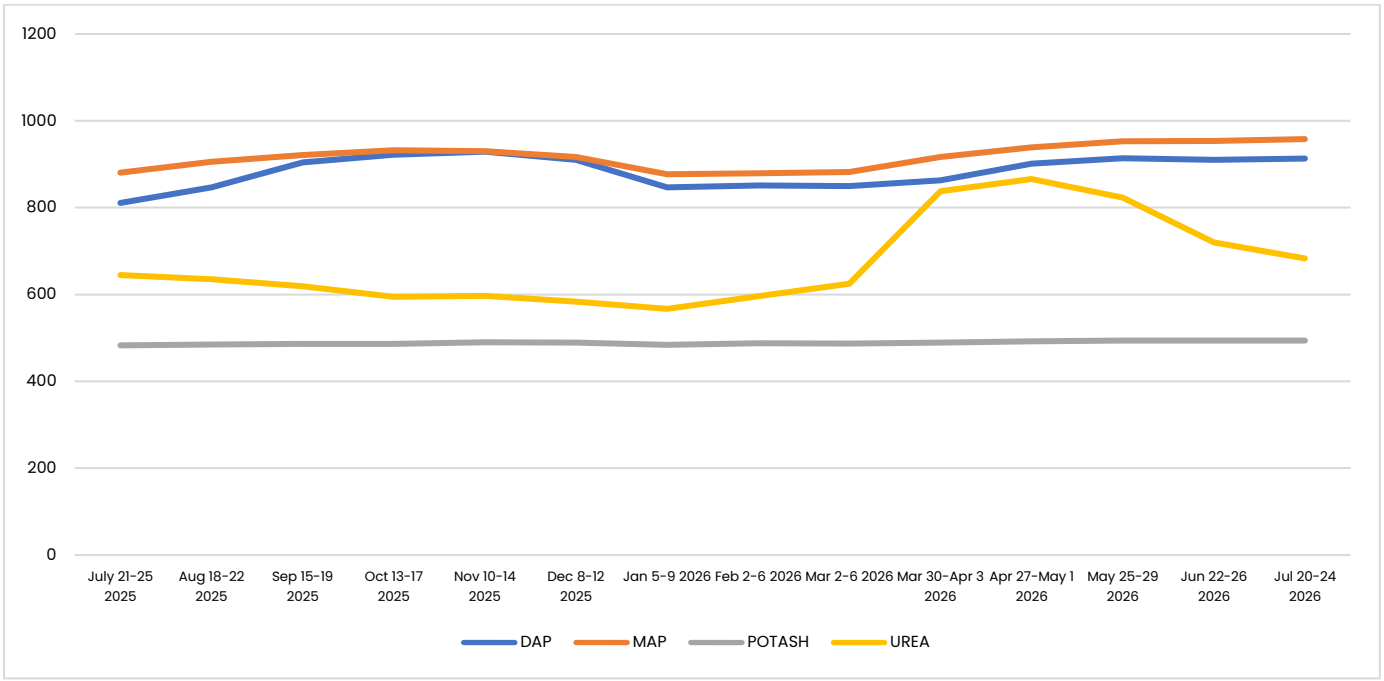
0.4% monthly increase and an 8.7% annual increase, indicating continued firm demand and supportive market fundamentals. Potash prices remained unchanged at US$494/MT, posting a modest 2.3% increase year-on-year. The stability in potash prices suggests balanced market conditions, with neither significant supply disruptions nor major shifts in demand affecting prices over the review period. In contrast, urea prices declined sharply to US$683/MT, falling by 5.1% month-on-month, the steepest monthly decline among the fertilizers tracked. Nevertheless, urea prices remained 5.9% higher than a year earlier, indicating that despite the recent correction, prices continue to be supported by gains recorded earlier in the year. The July decline extends the downward trend observed since late April 2026, when urea prices peaked at US$866/MT, suggesting that markets are gradually adjusting after a period of exceptionally strong price increases.

At country level (**Table 4**), fertilizer prices showed mixed trends across Africa, with East African markets continuing to record some of the highest annual increases despite recent short-term corrections. In Rwanda, fertilizer prices remained elevated, with NPK and urea increasing by 54.9% and 59.5% year-on-year, respectively. Monthly gains were also notable at 7.4% for NPK and 16.7% for urea, while six-month increases exceeded 26% for both products, indicating sustained upward pressure on fertilizer markets. In Uganda, trends were mixed. DAP prices declined by 13.9% over the past month but remained 81.5% higher than six months ago and 6.0% above year-earlier levels, reflecting previous periods of sharp price escalation. NPK prices fell 18.4% month-on-month and 15.4% over three months, although they were still 7.9% higher than six months ago and 17.1% above last year's levels, suggesting some easing after earlier supply tightness.

Malawi continued to experience moderate price growth. NPK and urea prices rose by 4.0% and 4.8% month-on-month, respectively, while annual increases reached 38.9% for NPK and 37.8% for urea. Six-month gains of about 13-15% further indicate persistent inflationary pressures in fertilizer markets. In Mozambique, fertilizer prices remained on an upward trajectory. NPK and urea prices increased modestly by 2.2% and 2.3% over the past month, but stronger growth was evident over longer periods, with annual increases of 40.7% and 57.9%, respectively. Six-month price growth was also substantial at 30.3% for NPK and 49.1% for urea, underscoring continued market tightness.

By contrast, Zambia experienced significant declines across both fertilizer products. NPK prices fell 17.3% month-on-month, 23.7% over three months, and 30.3% over six months, while urea prices declined 3.1%, 12.1%, and 29.2% over the same respective periods. These trends point to a marked easing of fertilizer prices in these countries due to government interventions such as subsidies. In Nigeria, fertilizer prices remained relatively stable compared to other markets. NPK prices declined slightly by 2.5% month-on-month and were virtually unchanged year-on-year (-0.2%), although they remained 9.9% higher than six months ago. Urea prices fell 7.6% over the past month and 0.8% over three months, but were still 24.8% higher than six months ago and 1.7% above year-earlier levels.

*Figure 3: Dry Fertiliser Prices ($/MT)*




***Source**: Author's construction based on DTN* [4]

[4] https://www.dtnpf.com/agriculture/web/ag/crops/article/2026/05/27/fertilizer-prices-fall-first-time-14

*Table 4: National Average Fertilizer Prices*

| Country | Crop | Market | Last Price | 1 Month % | 3 Months % | 6 Months % | 1 Year % |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Rwanda | NPK | National Average USD/50kg | 1,157.01 | 7.42 | 15.93 | 26.02 | 54.97 |
| Rwanda | Urea | National Average USD/50kg | 1,191.84 | 16.69 | 27.26 | 28.15 | 59.49 |
| Uganda | DAP | National Average, Retail, UGX/Kg | 6,727.27 | -13.92 | 59.97 | 81.48 | 6.00 |
| Uganda | NPK | National Average, Retail, UGX/Kg | 3,837.16 | -18.40 | -15.37 | 7.90 | 17.13 |
| Malawi | NPK | National Average, MWK/Kg | 4,095.87 | 4.00 | 18.72 | 14.91 | 38.92 |
| Malawi | Urea | National Average, MWK/Kg | 3,951.38 | 4.80 | -14.08 | 13.33 | 37.76 |
| Mozambique | NPK | National Average, MZN/Kg | 98.83 | 2.16 | 41.52 | 30.30 | 40.69 |
| Mozambique | Urea | National Average, MZN/Kg | 96.92 | 2.23 | 38.07 | 49.11 | 57.88 |
| Zambia | NPK | National Average, Retail, ZMW/KG | 18.80 | -17.30 | -23.72 | -30.28 | |
| Zambia | Urea | National Average, Retail, ZMW/KG | 18.76 | -3.06 | -12.11 | -29.23 | |
| Nigeria | Fertiliser_NPK | National Average, NGN/50KG | 977.32 | -2.51 | 0.94 | 9.89 | -0.21 |
| Nigeria | Fertiliser_Urea | National Average, NGN/50KG | 906.64 | -7.55 | -0.81 | 24.79 | 1.69 |

**Source:** *AGRA MIS data*

## Update on the Impacts of the US-Iran Crisis

Over the last month, the conflict between the United States and Iran intensified after the collapse of a fragile June 2026 memorandum of understanding (MoU). On 27 June 2026, both countries exchanged strikes following incidents involving commercial shipping in the Strait of Hormuz, with each side accusing the other of violating the ceasefire framework.[5] The situation escalated further on 7 to 8 July when the United States launched attacks on more than 80 Iranian military targets and reinstated stringent oil sanctions after several tankers were struck in the Strait of Hormuz. Iran subsequently retaliated against U.S. interests and regional allies, raising fears of a broader regional war. Despite intermittent diplomatic efforts mediated by Oman, renewed missile exchanges and military operations continued through late July, indicating that the conflict remains highly volatile.[6]

The most significant economic consequence has been the disruption of maritime trade through the Strait of Hormuz, one of the world's most critical energy corridors. During the recent escalation, Iran effectively restricted vessel movements, and reports indicated that several vessels were turned back or redirected, while shipping traffic remained significantly below normal levels. Oil markets reacted sharply: Brent crude briefly exceeded US$102 per barrel in July before retreating to around US$92 following temporary de-escalation efforts, while renewed hostilities caused daily price surges of 3% to 8%.[7] The heightened security risks also increased insurance premiums and transportation costs for shipping companies operating in the Gulf region.

The broader impact on global trade has been substantial. Iran reported crude oil sales worth approximately US$11.5 billion during the conflict period, but U.S. sanctions and naval restrictions continued to threaten export revenues and supply chains. Higher energy prices have contributed to inflationary pressures, increased production costs, and slower economic growth projections in several economies. For example, France cited the Iran conflict and associated energy market disruptions as factors weighing on economic activity, despite recording modest GDP growth of 0.2% in the second quarter of 2026.[8] Consequently, the ongoing U.S.-Iran conflict has evolved from a regional security issue into a major risk factor for global trade, energy security, and economic stability.

Global grain markets rebounded strongly on 15 July after escalating tensions in the Middle East pushed Brent crude oil prices, prompting renewed investor interest in agricultural commodities.[9] Because energy prices influence transportation, fertilizer costs, and biofuel demand, the surge in oil prices provided support for grain markets, with wheat, corn, and soybeans all posting gains. The development underscores the growing interconnectedness between geopolitical events, energy markets, and agricultural commodity prices.

Corn futures rose by 4 to 5 cents per bushel, with September contracts trading around US$4.47 per bushel, supported by strong export demand and ethanol consumption. The USDA rated 68% of the U.S. corn crop as good to excellent, while weekly exports reached 42.5 million bushels, with Mexico remaining the largest buyer. Soybeans showed more

[5] US, Iran trade strikes: What to know, will it unravel the MoU? | US-Israel war on Iran News | Al Jazeera

[6] U.S. pauses Iran strikes for second straight night as talks move in positive direction; US strikes Iran as widening war engulfs more countries - AL-MONITOR: The Middle East's leading independent news source since 2012

[7] Oil Prices Surge 3% as US Strikes Iran and Revokes Oil Sanctions Waiver | Markets.com

[8] France's economy stages modest Q2 recovery despite Iran war, US tariffs

[9] People Daily. (2026, July 15). Global grain markets rebound as Middle East tensions drive oil prices higher and boost agricultural commodities, cited in RATIN

mixed performance, although prices remained supported by robust Chinese demand. The USDA reported that 65% of the U.S. soybean crop was in good-to-excellent condition, with crop development progressing ahead of historical averages. However, expectations of a record Brazilian soybean harvest of 6.636 billion bushels are likely to increase global supplies and limit future price gains[10].

Wheat emerged as the strongest performer, with some contracts gaining as much as 3.5% during the trading session. Chicago soft red winter wheat futures reached US$6.45 per bushel, while Kansas City hard red winter wheat futures climbed to US$6.78 per bushel, despite the U.S. winter wheat harvest being 67% complete. Concerns over crop quality, adverse weather conditions, and geopolitical uncertainty continued to support prices. Overall, the market rebound highlights how rising energy costs, weather risks, international trade disruptions, and biofuel demand are creating greater volatility in agriculture. Analysts note that if geopolitical tensions persist and oil prices remain elevated, grain markets could establish a firmer price floor, with implications for farm incomes, livestock feed costs, supply chains, and global agricultural trade.[11]

Fuel prices across Africa (**Table 5**) showed varied movements between June and July, although prices generally remained above March levels in most countries. Rwanda continued to record the largest overall increases, with petrol and diesel prices remaining 48% and 50% above March levels respectively by July, indicating sustained fuel cost pressures. Tanzania also maintained substantial increases despite monthly declines in July, with petrol prices 36% higher and diesel prices 39% higher than in March. Kenya and Uganda continued to experience elevated fuel costs. Kenya's petrol and diesel prices remained unchanged between June and July but were still 20% and 34% above March levels respectively. Uganda recorded a 2% monthly increase in petrol prices, while diesel declined slightly by 1%; however, compared to March, petrol and diesel prices remained significantly higher at 28% and 36%, reflecting ongoing pressure on transport and logistics costs.

In Southern Africa, Mozambique recorded the sharpest diesel inflation, with diesel prices remaining 85% above March levels, while petrol increased by 14%. Zambia, by contrast, experienced further easing in July, with petrol and diesel prices declining by 3% and 4% respectively from June. As a result, petrol prices were 5% below March levels, while diesel prices remained 16% higher. Malawi presented a mixed picture, with petrol prices remaining 13% above March levels, but diesel prices fell sharply in July, dropping 30% from June and ending 11% below March levels.

In West Africa, Ghana registered moderate but sustained increases, with petrol prices 25% higher and diesel prices 18% higher than in March. Nigeria showed mixed trends, with petrol prices rising by 3% between June and July and standing 3% above March levels, while diesel prices declined by 2% during the month and were 12% below March levels.

Overall, diesel prices remained higher than petrol prices in most countries and continued to show stronger cumulative increases than petrol, particularly in Rwanda, Kenya, Uganda, Tanzania, and Mozambique. However, the July data also indicate emerging price moderation in some markets, notably Zambia, Malawi, and Nigeria, where diesel prices either declined significantly or fell below March levels, suggesting some easing of fuel-related cost pressures in parts of Southern and West Africa.

*Table 5: Fuel Prices (in local currencies)*

| Country | March | | June | | July | | Changes (%) June/July | | Changes (%) March/July | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Petrol | Diesel | Petrol | Diesel | Petrol | Diesel | Petrol | Diesel | Petrol | Diesel |
| Kenya | 178.28 | 166.54 | 214.03 | 222.86 | 214 | 222.86 | 0% | 0% | 20% | 34% |
| Rwanda | 1989 | 1948 | 2938 | 2927 | 2938 | 2927 | 0% | 0% | 48% | 50% |
| Tanzania | 2864 | 2858 | 3990 | 4182 | 3898 | 3978 | -2% | -5% | 36% | 39% |
| Uganda | 5158 | 4831 | 6499 | 6599 | 6600 | 6560 | 2% | -1% | 28% | 36% |
| Malawi | 4965 | 4945 | 5619 | 6306 | 5619 | 4389 | 0% | -30% | 13% | -11% |
| Mozambique | 82.5 | 62.775 | 93.86 | 116.25 | 93.69 | 116.25 | 0% | 0% | 14% | 85% |
| Zambia | 26.61 | 23.25 | 26.15 | 28.11 | 25.29 | 26.89 | -3% | -4% | -5% | 16% |
| Ghana | 11.57 | 14.35 | 14.51 | 15.92 | 14.45 | 16.94 | 0% | 6% | 25% | 18% |
| Nigeria | 1290 | 2010 | 1290 | 1800 | 1330 | 1770 | 3% | -2% | 3% | -12% |

[10] Ibid
[11] Ibid

## Update on El Niño conditions

The 2026 El Niño is expected to be exceptionally strong, with an 81 percent likelihood of reaching very strong intensity between October and December, according to NOAA's July 2026 ENSO outlook, making it one of the strongest events recorded since 1950. El Niño conditions are forecast to persist through April 2027, with a 97 percent probability.[12] To date, the event has already contributed to significant rainfall deficits across East Africa, Central America, India, and Southeast Asia, raising concerns about drought impacts on agriculture, water resources, and food security in these regions.

Africa could face an economic loss of US$10-20 billion from a potential "super" El Niño event, according to the African Development Bank (AfDB). The bank estimates that the phenomenon could reduce GDP in heavily affected African countries by 1% to 2% on average, making it one of the most significant climate-related economic threats to the continent's near-term growth prospects.[13] The report notes that El Niño is expected to bring severe droughts across parts of Southern Africa and heavy rainfall and flooding in East Africa, with major implications for food and water security. Agriculture is likely to be particularly vulnerable, with crop failures, livestock losses, and rising food prices expected to worsen food insecurity. The AfDB also estimates that African farmers are already facing nearly US$330 million in lost income, while fisheries and coastal communities may experience additional challenges from rising sea temperatures, storms, and sea-level changes (Reuters, 2026). Beyond the direct economic impact, the AfDB warns that El Niño could damage critical infrastructure, increase debt pressures, and trigger significant migration from severely affected regions. The bank highlights the risk of a "climate finance trap," where governments divert funding away from health, education, and infrastructure to finance disaster response and recovery. To strengthen resilience and adaptation efforts, Africa's climate financing needs could rise to approximately US$100 billion, reflecting the escalating cost of managing climate-related risks (Reuters, 2026).

In Kenya, Baringo County is facing a severe maize production crisis after prolonged drought destroyed crops across key farming areas, with county authorities estimating that about 75% of the expected maize harvest has been lost and crop losses reaching up to 80% in some lowland areas.[14] The situation has left many farmers with significant financial losses, including those who borrowed money to fund planting, while reduced water levels in River Pekerra have limited irrigation and offered little relief. The crisis has been worsened by insecurity in parts of the county and shrinking pasture, which is forcing pastoralists to move livestock into forested areas in search of grazing land. Coming shortly after crop failures in Trans-Nzoia, another major grain-producing region, the poor harvest in Baringo is raising concerns about national food security, potential increases in maize and maize flour prices, and pressure on Kenya's grain stocks. In response, the government is preparing food security interventions, subsidized farm inputs for the next planting season, and implementation of the National El Niño Contingency Plan ahead of forecast El Niño rains expected between October and January.

[12] Climate Prediction Center: ENSO Diagnostic Discussion; El Niño 2026-2027 | FEWS NET

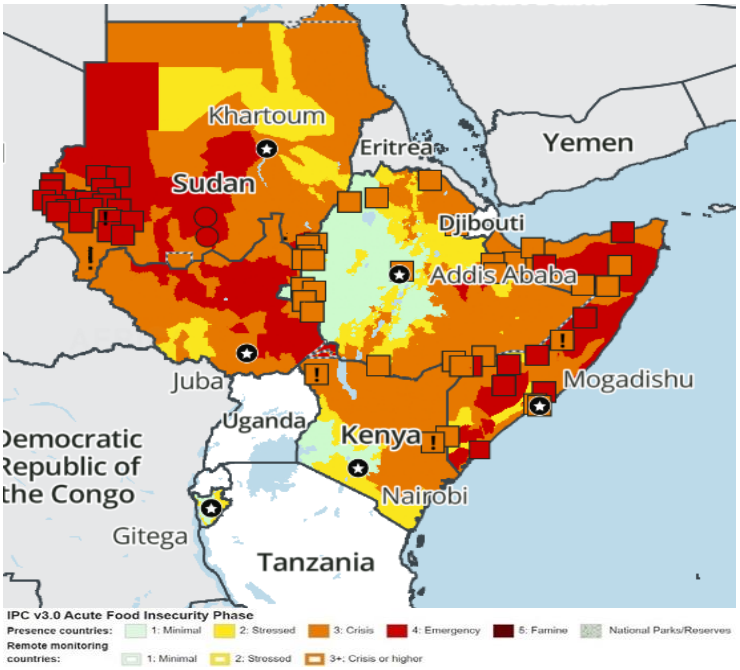
[13] Reuters. (2026, July 26). Africa facing up to $20 billion economic hit from "super" El Niño, AfDB climate chief warns. El Niño could cost Africa up to $20bn - Africa Briefing

[14] https://ratin.net/home/news/article/1277

# East Africa Food Insecurity Updates

## Food Security Outlook

*Figure 4: East African Countries Food Security Outlook, July 2026*




**Ethiopia** continues to face widespread Crisis (IPC Phase 3) food insecurity as millions of households struggle to meet their food needs during the peak June to August lean season, driven by high food prices, limited income opportunities, and increased market dependence, particularly among IDPs, refugees, and poor crop-dependent households.[15] Although improved rainfall in late July supported planting and reduced the likelihood of widespread crop failure, El Niño-induced rainfall deficits, delayed seasonal onset, and poor rainfall distribution have significantly affected agricultural production, especially in northern and eastern regions such as Amhara, Tigray, Afar, and parts of Oromia. Both the belg and upcoming meher harvests are expected to be below average, limiting household food stocks and income recovery.

In pastoral areas, poor livestock productivity, reduced herd sizes, and constrained pasture and water resources are expected to sustain Crisis outcomes through early 2027. At the same time, persistently high food prices, with staple costs remaining well above historical averages, continue to erode purchasing power, while disruptions and low coverage of humanitarian assistance have reduced a critical source of support for vulnerable populations. While the meher harvest is anticipated to bring some improvement to Stressed (IPC Phase 2) conditions from October in some cropping areas, the gains are expected to be limited and short-lived due to below-average production and ongoing economic pressures.

**Kenya's** food security outlook remains mixed through January 2027. Pastoral areas are expected to remain in Crisis (IPC Phase 3) through September due to seasonal drying, declining pasture and water availability, reduced livestock productivity, and lower milk production, but most areas are projected to improve to Stressed (IPC Phase 2) after the expected above-average October-December short rains, although Mandera will likely remain in Crisis because of slow recovery from the failed 2025 short rains.[16] Refugee populations in Kakuma, Dadaab, and Kalobeyei are expected to face persistent Crisis! (IPC Phase 3!) conditions, with humanitarian assistance preventing worse outcomes, while any interruption in aid could result in Emergency (IPC Phase 4) levels of food insecurity. Marginal agricultural areas are expected to remain Stressed (IPC Phase 2), supported by long-rains harvests, agricultural labour opportunities, and short-rains production, although households will continue relying on coping strategies to meet non-food needs. National crop prospects are uneven: near-average production is expected in many southeastern and coastal marginal farming areas, but maize yields in key grain-producing regions of the North Rift and western Kenya are likely to be substantially below average due to prolonged rainfall deficits, potentially causing about 15 percent yield losses and sustaining pressure on staple food prices. Meanwhile, the government is preparing for forecast El Niño-related flooding during the October-December rains through coordinated disaster preparedness and response measures.

**South Sudan** is facing widespread and severe food insecurity, with Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes persisting through the peak lean season due to conflict, displacement, high food prices, currency depreciation, and worsening drought conditions linked to El Niño. The most critical conditions are in Akobo, Nyirol, Ulang, and Nasir, where some households are already experiencing Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5) and a credible risk of Famine (IPC Phase 5) exists through January 2027 if conflict further restricts access to food, wild foods, and humanitarian assistance.[17] Although humanitarian aid is helping reduce the severity of food insecurity in several counties, insecurity, funding shortfalls, and attacks on aid operations continue to limit access. Ongoing clashes and intercommunal violence are disrupting markets, crop production, livelihoods, and population movements, while below-average rainfall, extreme soil moisture

[15] https://fews.net/east-africa/ethiopia
[16] https://fews.net/east-africa/kenya
[17] https://fews.net/east-africa/south-sudan

deficits, crop failures, deteriorating pasture conditions, and delayed planting are threatening harvest prospects. At the same time, rising fuel and staple food prices are further eroding household purchasing power, particularly in conflict-affected areas, and expected harvests are unlikely to offset declining assistance and broader economic and climatic pressures.

**Uganda's** food security situation is expected to remain challenging through January 2027, with Crisis (IPC Phase 3) outcomes projected across Karamoja and northern refugee camps, while southern refugee settlements are likely to deteriorate from Stressed! (IPC Phase 2!) to Crisis conditions as food stocks decline and humanitarian assistance becomes insufficient.[18] The most severe concerns are in Karamoja, where below average and poorly distributed rainfall has caused estimated crop losses of 50 to 70 percent, reduced vegetation and pasture conditions, weakened livestock productivity, and lowered incomes from livestock sales. Food needs are expected to peak between October and November as harvests are depleted, harvest prospects remain poor, and refugee numbers continue to rise. Although the government launched emergency food assistance in July targeting nearly 314,000 households in Karamoja, the support is expected only to partially mitigate food consumption gaps. Persistently high fuel costs have increased the prices of processed foods, goods, and services, further constraining household purchasing power, while Ebola-related movement and market restrictions have disrupted informal trade and daily labour opportunities for vulnerable households. Despite improved food availability in many bimodal areas following seasonal harvests, poor households in Karamoja and refugee populations remain under significant food security pressure.

## Commodity Prices

*Key drivers of commodity prices in EA*

| | |
|---|---|
| **Conflicts** | Conflicts and insecurity persist, particularly in South Sudan and Ethiopia, hindering effective price stability and trade flows. |
| **Seasonal Dynamics** | Above average rainfall in some areas such as Uganda resulted in rising of Nile River water levels affecting crops in 13 counties across four states hence affecting prices. |
| **Macroeconomic Shocks** | South Sudan continues to experience high prices due to poor macroeconomic conditions, currency depreciation, and trade disruptions. |

### Maize

*Figure 5: National average price spreads for maize across select East African Countries[19]*

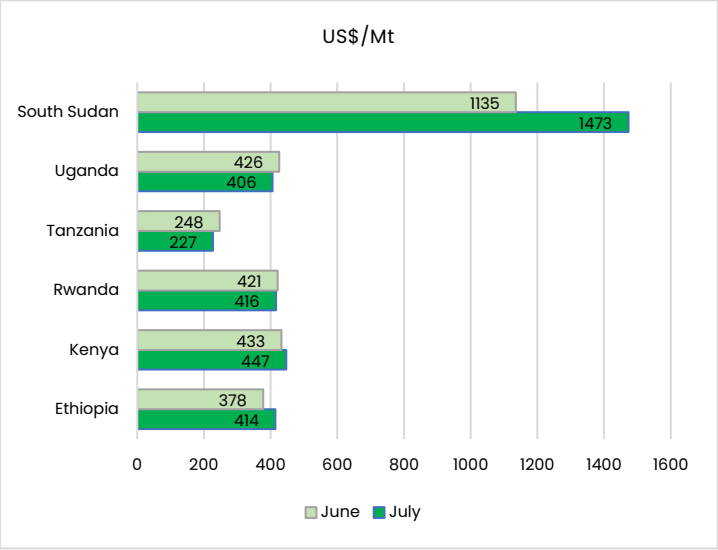



**Figure 5** presents maize prices (USD/metric tonne) across six Eastern African countries. showing mixed movements between June and July. **South Sudan** recorded the sharpest increase, with prices surging by 29.8% from USD 1,135/MT to USD 1,473/MT, reflecting severe supply constraints, persistent macroeconomic challenges, and market disruptions that continue to exert upward pressure on food prices. In contrast, **Ethiopia** and **Kenya** registered more moderate increases of 9.5% and 3.3%, respectively, with prices rising from USD 378/MT and USD433/MT to USD 414/MT and USD 447/MT respectively. These increases were primarily driven by tightening domestic supplies, particularly in Kenya, where erratic rainfall adversely affected harvests and reduced market availability, prompting consideration of increased imports to stabilize supplies and prices[20]. **Rwanda** remained relatively stable, registering a marginal 1.2% decline from USD 426/MT to USD 421/MT. Meanwhile, more pronounced reductions were observed in surplus-producing markets. **Uganda** experienced a 4.7% decline, with prices falling from USD 426/MT to USD 406/MT, reflecting improved supplies and continued harvest arrivals. **Tanzania** recorded the sharpest decline in maize prices among the monitored

[18] https://fews.net/east-africa/uganda

[19] These price spreads are calculated based on online rates at https://www.oanda.com/currency-converter/en

[20] **Maize prices jump as poor harvest shrinks supply**https://nation.africa/kenya/business/maize-prices-jump-as-poor-harvest-shrinks-supply-5535220#story

countries, with prices falling by 9.2%, from USD 248/MT to USD 227/MT, reinforcing the country's position as the most competitively priced maize market in the region. The decline was driven by ample market supplies following the *Masika* and *Msimu* harvests, with national maize production estimated at 7.3 million tonnes[21]. However, the government launched NFRA maize purchases aimed at boosting farm-gate prices to reverse the recent downward price trend[22].

**Table 6** further summarizes maize prices in local currencies across East African countries, highlighting a mixed market situation characterized by significant price increases in some countries and notable declines in others. **South Sudan** recorded the sharpest month-on-month increase, with prices rising by 22.9%, while **Ethiopia** also registered substantial increases of 20.0% in Bahir Dar and 9.8% at the national level, reflecting tightening supplies, inflationary pressures, and broader market challenges. **Kenya** recorded a more moderate increase of 3.2%, suggesting emerging supply constraints and seasonal market tightening. Conversely, maize prices declined in Tanzania (-7.7%), **Uganda** (-3.0%), and **Rwanda** (-1.0%), largely driven by improved harvests and increased market availability. **Tanzania** posted the strongest downward trend, with prices falling by 25.0% over the past three months and 33.3% over six months, reinforcing its position as the region's most competitive maize supplier.

*Table 6: Percentage changes in maize prices in East Africa*[23]

| Country | Crop | Market | Last Price | 1 Month % | 3 Months % | 6 Months % | 1 Year % |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Ethiopia | White Maize (Quintal) | Bahir Dar kebele, Retail, ETB/100kg | 6,000.00 | 20.00 ⊗ | 20.97 ⊗ | 33.33 ⊗ | 46.34 ⊗ |
| Ethiopia | White Maize (Quintal) | National average, Retail, ETB/100kg | 6,651.88 | 9.80 ↑ | 11.34 ↑ | 45.13 ⊗ | 49.48 ⊗ |
| Kenya | Maize | National Average, Retail, KES/KG | 57.36 | 3.18 △ | 3.75 △ | -1.97 ↘ | 5.64 ↑ |
| Rwanda | Maize | National Average, Retail, RWF/Kg | 608.05 | -0.99 ↘ | -2.89 ↘ | -5.77 ↓ | 6.11 ↑ |
| South Sudan | Maize (white) | National Average, Retail, SSP/Kg* | 7,361.47 | 22.95 ⊗ | 47.91 ⊗ | 71.64 ⊗ | 56.01 ⊗ |
| Tanzania | Maize (Mahindi) | National Average, Wholesale, TZS/100KG | 60,000.00 | -7.69 ↓ | -25.00 ↓ | -33.33 ↓ | -25.00 ↓ |
| Uganda | Maize | National Average, Retail, UGX/Kg | 1,507.85 | -3.04 ↘ | -17.68 ↓ | 10.53 ↑ | -19.48 ↓ |

**Note**: Latest price is for July 2026, * June 2026, and ** May 2026

● = no change, △ = low increase (0-5%), ↑ = moderate increase (5-15%), ⊗ = high increase (>15%), ↘ = low decrease (0-5%), ↓ = moderate decrease (5-15%), ↓ = high decrease (>15%)

## Rice

*Figure 6: National average price spreads for rice across select East African Countries*[24]

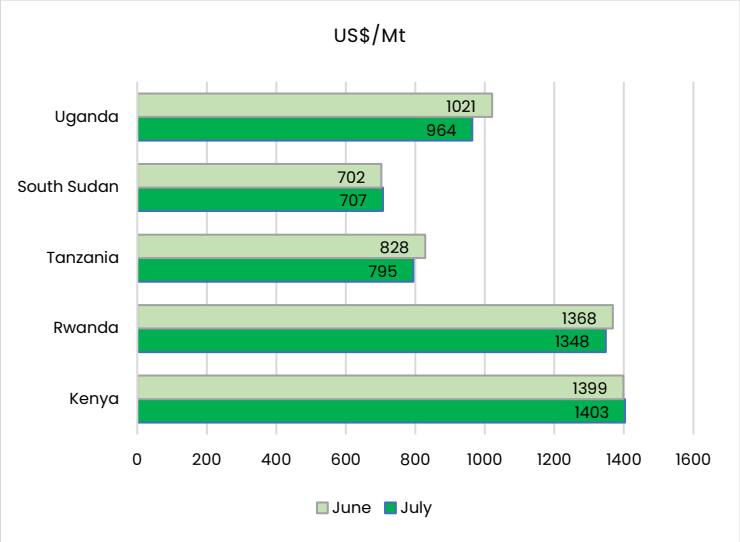



**Figure 6** presents rice prices (in USD per metric tonne) across select Eastern African countries, showing broadly declining prices between June and July. **Kenya** remained the highest-priced rice market in the region, with prices edging up by 0.3% from USD 1,399/MT to USD 1,403/MT, reflecting sustained demand and continued dependence on imported rice supplies. **South Sudan** also recorded a slight increase of 0.7%, with prices rising from USD 702/MT to USD 707/MT, suggesting relative market stability despite ongoing supply challenges.

In contrast, **Rwanda** experienced a 1.5% decline, with prices easing from USD 1,368/MT to USD 1,348/MT, reflecting improved market availability and regional inflows. **Uganda** recorded a more pronounced 5.6% decrease, with prices falling from USD 1,021/MT to USD 964/MT, supported by increased supplies following recent harvests and easing market pressures. Similarly, **Tanzania** registered a 4.0% decline, with prices falling from USD 828/MT to USD 795/MT. The decrease was largely driven by improved domestic supplies, as paddy rice production is forecast at 4.3 million tonnes, approximately 10% above the historical average[25]. Higher production, supported by increased planting in response to previously strong market prices, has enhanced market availability and reinforced Tanzania's position as one of the most competitively priced rice markets in the region.

[21] https://reliefweb.int/report/united-republic-tanzania/giews-country-brief-united-republic-tanzania-10-july-2026
[22] https://ratin.net/home/news/article/1221
[23] Author's construction based on 1) AGRA MIS data for Rwanda and Uganda; 2) FAO data for South Sudan, 3) National MIS Ethiopia, Kenya & Tanzania
[24] These price spreads are calculated based on online rates at https://www.oanda.com/currency-converter/en
[25] https://www.fao.org/giews/countrybrief/country.jsp?code=TZA

**Table 7** presents rice prices in local currencies across selected East African countries, showing mixed market trends during the reporting period. In **Kenya**, Komboka rice prices declined by 2.6% to KES 119.78/kg month-on-month, remaining below levels recorded three months (-4.2%), six months (-3.1%), and one year (-7.4%) earlier. In contrast, Pishori rice prices increased marginally by 0.2% to KES 180.23/kg, supported by relatively stable market conditions, although they remained slightly lower than a year ago (-0.4%). In **Rwanda**, rice prices declined by 1.5% to RWF 1,968.89/kg but remained significantly higher than six months ago (+7.6%) and a year earlier (+31.7%), indicating continued underlying market tightness despite the recent easing.

**South Sudan** recorded a 2.7% month-on-month increase, with rice prices rising to SSP 3,530.56/kg. Stronger gains were observed over longer periods, with prices increasing by 10.7% over three months, 30.3% over six months, and 26.1% year-on-year, reflecting tightening supplies and persistent inflationary pressures. **Tanzania** registered a 3.5% month-on-month price decline to TZS 210,000 per 100 kg, with prices remaining substantially lower than three months ago (-13.9%), six months ago (-17.7%), and one year ago (-9.7%), reflecting improved market supplies from recent harvests and easing domestic price pressures. In **Uganda**, trends varied between rice varieties, with Kaiso rice prices falling by 3.9% to UGX 3,580.24/kg month-on-month, and remained lower across all reference periods, while Super rice prices increased by 1.8% to UGX 4,832.54/kg, and were 7.6% higher than a year earlier, suggesting stronger demand for higher-value rice segments. Overall, the rice market remains relatively stable across East Africa, with ample supplies in Tanzania and parts of Uganda helping moderate regional price pressures, while South Sudan and Rwanda continue to experience comparatively elevated market conditions.

*Table 7: Percentage changes in rice prices in East Africa*[26]

| Country | Crop | Market | Last Price | 1 Month % | 3 Months % | 6 Months % | 1 Year % |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Kenya | Rice_komboka | National Average, Retail, KES/KG | 119.78 | -2.63 ↘ | -4.23 ↘ | -3.05 ↘ | -7.40 ↓ |
| Kenya | Rice_pishori | National Average, Retail, KES/KG | 180.23 | 0.23 ▲ | 1.68 ▲ | 0.00 ▲ | -0.44 ↘ |
| Rwanda | Rice | National Average, Retail, RWF/Kg | 1,968.89 | -1.45 ↘ | -1.80 ↘ | 7.55 ↑ | 31.68 ⊗ |
| South Sudan | Rice | National Average, Retail, SSP/Kg* | 3,530.56 | 2.70 ▲ | 10.68 ↑ | 30.32 ⊗ | 26.10 ⊗ |
| Tanzania | Rice (Mchele) | National Average, Wholesale, TZS/100KG | 210,000.00 | -3.45 ↘ | -13.93 ↓ | -17.65 ↓ | -9.68 ↓ |
| Uganda | Rice_kaiso | National Average, Retail, UGX/Kg | 3,580.24 | -3.87 ↘ | -3.62 ↘ | -2.98 ↘ | -0.97 ↘ |
| Uganda | Rice_super | National Average, Retail, UGX/Kg | 4,832.54 | 1.79 ▲ | 1.25 ▲ | 2.65 ▲ | 7.57 ↑ |

**Note**: Latest price is for July 2026, * June 2026, and ** May 2026

● = no change, ▲ = low increase (0-5%), ↑ = moderate increase (5-15%), ⊗ = high increase (>15%),
↘ = low decrease (0-5%), ↓ = moderate decrease (5-15%), ↓ = high decrease (>15%)

## Beans

*Figure 7: National average price spreads for beans across select East African Countries*[27]

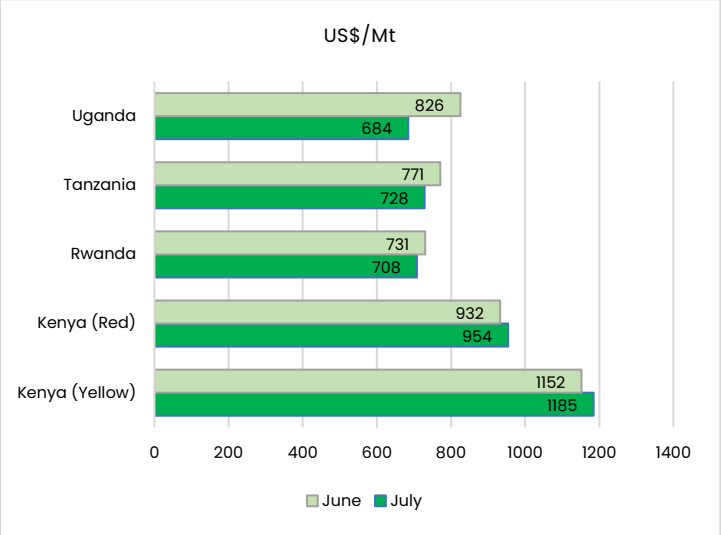



**Figure 7** presents beans prices (in USD per metric tonne) across selected Eastern African markets, showing broad-based declines. **Kenya**'s yellow beans registered the largest increase among the monitored markets, rising by 2.9% from USD 1,152/MT to USD 1,185/MT, while red beans increased by 2.4%, from USD 932/MT to USD 954/MT. These gains reflect tightening domestic supplies and sustained consumer demand amid continued reliance on regional imports.

In contrast, the remaining markets experienced price declines. **Uganda** recorded the sharpest reduction, with prices falling by 17.2% from USD 826/MT to USD 684/MT, reflecting improved market availability following harvest inflows and subdued regional demand. **Tanzania** also posted a notable decline of 5.6%, with prices decreasing from USD 771/MT to USD 728/MT, suggesting increased supplies and competitive exports. **Rwanda** experienced a more moderate 3.1% decline, with prices easing from USD 731/MT to USD 708/MT, supported by improved domestic availability and cross-border inflows.

[26] Author's construction based on 1) AGRA MIS data for Rwanda and Uganda; 2) FAO data for South Sudan, 3) National MIS Ethiopia, Kenya & Tanzania

[27] These price spreads are calculated based on online rates at https://www.oanda.com/currency-converter/en

**Table 8** presents bean prices in local currencies across selected East African countries, showing a predominantly downward trend during the reporting period. In **Kenya**, Wairimu bean prices increased by 2.2% to KES 122.50/kg, while Yellow bean prices rose by 2.8% to KES 152.15/kg. Despite these monthly gains, prices for both varieties remained below levels recorded three months ago, six months ago, and a year earlier, indicating improved market supplies compared to previous periods.

In **Rwanda**, bean prices declined by 3.0% month-on-month to RWF 1,034.44/kg. However, prices remained 1.3% higher than three months ago, 18.1% above six-month levels, and 5.7% higher than a year earlier, suggesting that despite the recent easing, underlying market conditions remain relatively firm. **Tanzania** recorded a 4.9% decline, with wholesale bean prices falling to TZS 192,500 per 100 kg. Prices are also significantly lower than three months ago (-9.2%), six months ago (-16.3%), and a year earlier (-21.4%), reflecting improved harvests and ample market supplies. The steepest decline was recorded in **Uganda**, where bean prices dropped by 15.6% month-on-month to UGX 2,541.67/kg. Prices were also lower over the three-month (-8.2%), six-month (-12.3%), and annual (-10.0%) periods, indicating strong domestic availability and reduced market pressure.

Overall, the bean market across East Africa remains generally well supplied, particularly in Tanzania and Uganda, where abundant harvests continue to exert downward pressure on prices.

*Table 8: Percentage changes in bean prices in East Africa*[28]

| Country | Crop | Market | Last Price | 1 Month % | 3 Months % | 6 Months % | 1 Year % |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Kenya | Beans_wairimu | National Average, Retail, KES/KG | 122.50 | 2.24 | -10.72 | -4.54 | -3.79 |
| Kenya | Beans_yellow | National Average, Retail, KES/KG | 152.15 | 2.76 | -6.50 | -7.57 | -7.97 |
| Rwanda | Beans | National Average, Retail, RWF/Kg | 1,034.44 | -3.00 | 1.27 | 18.05 | 5.74 |
| Tanzania | Beans (Maharage) | National Average, Wholesale, TZS/100KG | 192,500.00 | -4.94 | -9.20 | -16.30 | -21.43 |
| Uganda | Beans | National Average, Retail, UGX/Kg | 2,541.67 | -15.63 | -8.18 | -12.27 | -9.99 |

**Note**: Latest price is for July 2026, * June 2026, and ** May 2026

= no change; = low increase (0-5%), = moderate increase (5-15%), = high increase (>15%), = low decrease (0-5%), = moderate decrease (5-15%), = high decrease (>15%)

## Wheat

*Figure 8: National average price spreads for wheat across select East African Countries*

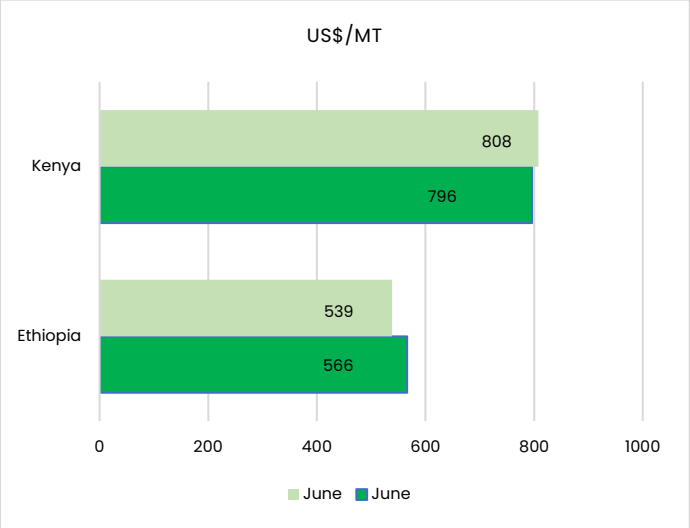



**Figure 8** presents wheat prices (in USD per metric tonne) across Kenya and Ethiopia, showing contrasting movements between June and July. **Kenya** remained the higher-priced wheat market despite a modest decline of 1.5%, with prices easing from USD 808/MT to USD 796/MT, likely reflecting improved availability from imports and recent harvests. However, wheat production is forecast to be approximately 1 million 90 kg bags this season, a significant decline from 1.7 million bags recorded last year. The decline is attributed to adverse weather conditions and a shift by farmers toward barley production, driven by more attractive market prices and profitability[29]. In contrast, **Ethiopia** average wheat price recorded a 5.0% increase, rising from USD 539/MT to USD 566/MT. The increase suggests tightening domestic supplies and sustained demand despite improved *belg* harvest supplies reaching southern and southwestern markets[30].

**Table 9** summarises wheat prices in local currencies across two select East African countries, showing relatively stable market conditions in Ethiopia and Kenya, albeit with divergent trends. In **Ethiopia**, wheat prices in the Bahir Dar market remained unchanged at ETB 10,000 per 100 kg across all reference periods, indicating a stable local market. However, the national average wheat price increased by 5.3% month-on-month to ETB 9,099.29 per 100 kg, and was also 6.1%

[28] Author's construction based on 1) FAO data for Rwanda & Uganda, 2) National MIS Kenya & Tanzania
[29] https://www.the-star.co.ke/news/2026-08-07-state-raises-wheat-producer-price-to-sh5100-per-bag
[30] https://fews.net/global/price-watch/july-2026/print

higher than three months ago, 16.6% above six-month levels, and 16.6% higher year-on-year. These sustained increases suggest tightening domestic supplies and continued inflationary pressure in the broader wheat market.
In contrast, **Kenya** recorded a 1.5% decline in wheat prices during the month, with prices falling to KES 102.29/kg. Prices were also 4.3% lower than three months ago, indicating improved market availability and easing short-term pressure. However, wheat prices remained marginally higher than six months ago (+0.6%) and one year ago (+1.6%), reflecting generally stable market conditions despite recent declines.

*Table 9: Percentage changes in wheat prices in East Africa*[31]

| Country | Crop | Market | Last Price | 1 Month % | 3 Months % | 6 Months % | 1 Year % |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Ethiopia | White Wheat (Quintal) | Bahir Dar kebele, Retail, ETB/100kg | 10,000.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 |
| Ethiopia | White Wheat (Quintal) | National average, Retail, ETB/100kg | 9,099.29 | 5.31 | 6.07 | 16.55 | 16.56 |
| Kenya | Wheat | National Average, Retail, KES/KG | 102.29 | -1.48 | -4.27 | 0.61 | 1.60 |

**Note**: Latest price is for July 2026, * June 2026, and ** May 2026
= no change; = low increase (0-5%), = moderate increase (5-15%), = high increase (>15%),
= low decrease (0-5%), = moderate decrease (5-15%), = high decrease (>15%)

## Seasonal Monitor and Cropping Conditions[32]

In **Eastern Africa**, 2026 main cropping season is being shaped by persistent rainfall deficits, resulting in deteriorating crop conditions and below-average production prospects across several key food-producing countries. While Tanzania has largely maintained favorable harvest outcomes, Kenya, Uganda, Rwanda, and Burundi face significant production challenges that could tighten regional food supplies and market availability in the coming months.
**Ethiopia's** *Belg* maize harvest was completed under generally poor conditions due to below-average rainfall and prolonged dry spells across most producing areas, although the former SNNPR[33] region performed relatively better. Agricultural production was further constrained by movement restrictions in the Amhara and Tigray regions. Meanwhile, *Meher* season cereals remain at the vegetative to reproductive stages, but significant rainfall deficits during the June-September *Kiremt* season, coupled with extreme heat in the Afar Region, have adversely affected crop conditions and weakened production prospects for the main season.

**Kenya** is experiencing the most severe impacts, particularly in the major maize-producing western highlands where erratic rainfall and prolonged moisture deficits since April have stunted crops and reduced yield potential. Preliminary assessments indicate maize yields could decline by around 15 percent, with national cereal production expected to be 15–30 percent below average and some localized crop failures likely. Coastal areas have also been affected by early-season dryness and high temperatures, although central regions performed relatively better. **Uganda** has completed first-season maize harvesting in most bimodal areas, but continued rainfall deficits have significantly weakened crop prospects in Karamoja and parts of the north. With dry conditions expected to persist through September, recovery opportunities remain limited, raising concerns for both late first-season crops and second-season maize planting.

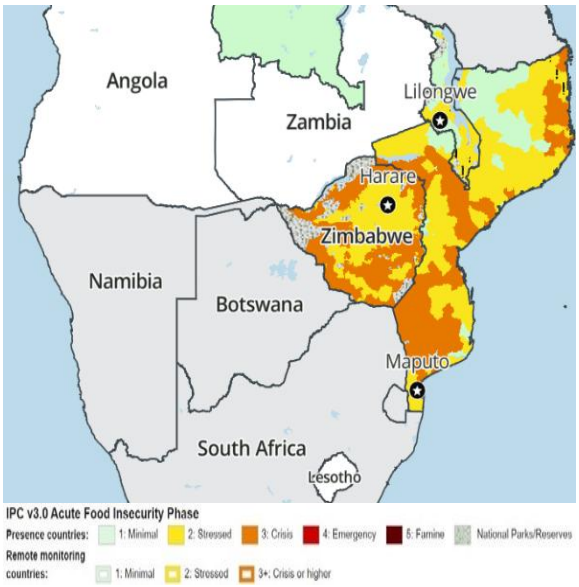
**Rwanda** finalized Season B maize and sorghum harvesting in July under generally poor conditions. Rainfall shortages during the growing season reduced biomass production, particularly in eastern regions, resulting in below-average harvest outcomes. Similarly, **Burundi** also completed Season B maize harvesting with reduced yields due to rainfall deficits, especially in western areas near Lake Tanganyika. Bean production was particularly hard hit by erratic rainfall patterns, waterlogging, and high fertilizer costs, with losses reaching 40–50 percent in some northern lowland areas. However, near-average cereal and tuber production is expected to partially offset these bean shortfalls. **Tanzania** remains a regional bright spot. *Msimu* harvests in unimodal areas and ongoing *Masika* harvests in bimodal zones have generally benefited from favorable rainfall conditions. Nonetheless, localized production losses occurred due to early-season dry spells, uneven rainfall distribution, and fertilizer supply disruptions linked to post-election logistical constraints. Despite these localized setbacks, aggregate cereal production in 2025 is forecast at a near-average 12.8 million tonnes, comprising 7.3 million tonnes of maize, which is 3 percent below the five-year average, and 4.3 million tonnes of paddy rice, which is 10 percent above average, supported by strong market prices and expanded planting areas.

[31] Author's construction based on 1) FAO data for Rwanda, South Sudan & Uganda, 2) National MIS Ethiopia, Kenya & Tanzania
[32] Crop Monitor No. 116 – June 2026: https://www.cropmonitor.org/s/EarlyWarning_CropMonitor_202606-x95c.pdf
[33] **SNNPR** refers to Southern Nations, Nationalities, and People's Region

Looking ahead, forecasts indicate above-average September-December rainfall associated with El Niño and positive Indian Ocean Dipole conditions. While these rains could support the next planting season and improve moisture availability, they may also increase flooding risks at the onset of planting activities across parts of the region.

## Southern Africa Food Security Update

*Figure 9: Southern Africa Countries Food Security Outlook, July 2026*




**Malawi** is experiencing generally favourable food security conditions during the post-harvest period, with Minimal (IPC Phase 1) and Stressed (IPC Phase 2) outcomes expected across most of the country through September as households rely on their own food stocks and income from crop sales.[34] However, parts of southern and central Malawi remain Stressed because below-average production and limited income opportunities are constraining households' ability to meet non-food needs. Looking ahead, Crisis (IPC Phase 3) outcomes are expected to emerge in parts of southern Malawi from October to January as poor households exhaust food stocks, become increasingly dependent on markets, and face elevated food prices and reduced agricultural labour opportunities. Although maize prices remained stable between June and July and are lower than last year, they remain above the five-year average, continuing to weaken purchasing power. Government interventions, including ADMARC maize purchases and efforts to replenish the Strategic Grain Reserve, are expected to support producer incomes and improve market supplies during the upcoming lean season. However, declining tobacco sales volumes and prices are reducing rural incomes and labour demand, while fuel prices, despite recent reductions, remain significantly above previous levels, contributing to higher transport and distribution costs and adding pressure to household livelihoods.

In **Mozambique**, food security situation remains mixed, with Crisis (IPC Phase 3) outcomes expected to persist in conflict-affected areas of northern Cabo Delgado through at least January 2027 due to ongoing insecurity, displacement, disrupted livelihoods, and limited market access, while some IDP-hosting areas benefit from humanitarian assistance that supports Stressed! (IPC Phase 2!) outcomes.[35] In southern and central Mozambique, Stressed (IPC Phase 2) conditions are prevailing as delayed second-season and post-flood harvests continue to improve food availability and income, although many households still struggle to meet essential non-food needs. Looking ahead, areas affected by conflict and earlier weather shocks are expected to deteriorate to Crisis (IPC Phase 3) as households become increasingly reliant on markets amid rising food prices, below-average incomes, and a likely late start to the 2026/27 agricultural season. El Niño is expected to worsen conditions in southern and central regions through below-average rainfall, prolonged dry spells, and reduced agricultural labour opportunities. Although maize prices declined seasonally in parts of the country, they remain above historical averages and continue to constrain food access for market-dependent households. Humanitarian assistance has reached hundreds of thousands of people, while lower levels of displacement compared to 2025 and ongoing security operations have helped improve market access and livelihood activities in some affected areas.

**Zambia's** food security situation is generally favourable due to a record 2026 harvest, but localized challenges persist. Minimal (IPC Phase 1) outcomes are expected across most of the country through January 2027, supported by above-average household food stocks, well-supplied markets, declining staple food prices, and improved purchasing power.[36] However, Stressed (IPC Phase 2) conditions are expected in parts of Western and Southern provinces and some eastern areas through September due to flood-related crop losses, prolonged dry spells, and livestock movement restrictions linked to Foot and Mouth Disease. From October to January, Stressed outcomes are expected to expand into parts of Western, Southern, Central, and Northern provinces as household food stocks decline and seasonal labour opportunities remain below average during the lean season. National maize supplies are expected to remain ample, supported by record production, carry-over stocks, and government grain procurement, while lower fuel prices are helping reduce transport costs and support seasonal declines in food prices, although remote deficit areas continue to face market access and supply constraints.

**In Zimbabwe,** the food security situation remains generally stable following the above-average 2026 harvest, but conditions are expected to deteriorate later in the year, particularly in deficit-producing areas.[37] Stressed (IPC Phase 2) outcomes are projected to persist through September as households continue relying on own-produced food

[34] https://fews.net/southern-africa/malawi
[35] https://fews.net/southern-africa/mozambique
[36] https://fews.net/southern-africa/zambia
[37] https://fews.net/southern-africa/zimbabwe

stocks and livelihood activities; however, Crisis (IPC Phase 3) conditions are expected to emerge from October as food stocks are depleted and households become increasingly dependent on markets despite weak purchasing power. Staple food prices remain elevated in deficit-producing regions due to limited grain supplies, while surplus-producing areas continue to benefit from lower maize prices and well-stocked markets. Household purchasing power is further constrained by persistently high fuel and transport costs, as well as the anticipated decline in remittances from South Africa following the return of large numbers of Zimbabwean migrants. Looking ahead, concerns over a potential El Niño-induced drought have prompted the government and development partners to implement preparedness measures, including strengthening grain reserves, facilitating grain imports, promoting drought-resilient agricultural practices, and expanding irrigation to mitigate future food security risks.

## Commodity Prices

*Key drivers of prices in the Southern Africa region*

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | **Seasonality Patterns** | Most Southern African countries are experiencing seasonal declines and stability in grain prices as the harvest season concludes despite the expected below-average harvests. |
| | **Weather Shocks** | The aftermath of the cyclone, drought shocks, and heavy flooding early in the planting season led to below-average harvests from the previous season, resulting in higher food prices. |
| | **Macroeconomic Shocks** | Poor macroeconomic conditions caused by forex shortages, power shortages, high food inflation, and high debt repayments sustain higher food prices. |

### Maize

*Figure 10: National average price spreads for maize across select Southern African Countries[38]*

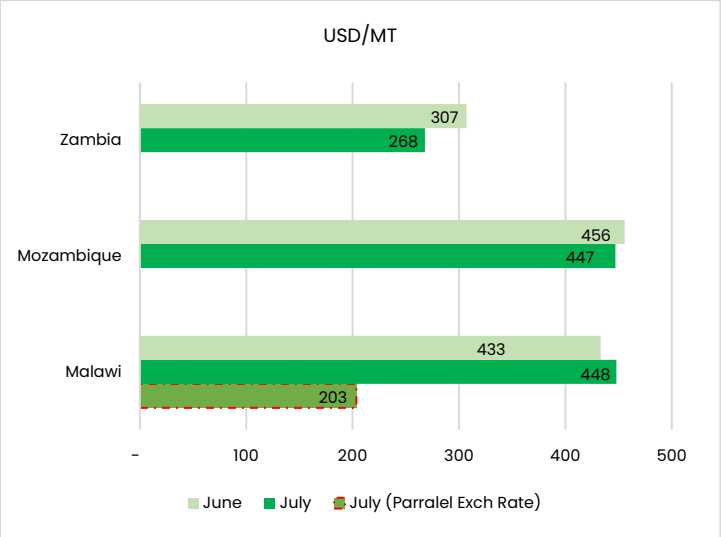



**Figure 10** illustrates maize price movements (in USD per metric tonne) across Southern African, showing mixed trends. In **Malawi**, maize prices increased by 3.5%, rising from USD 433/MT to USD 448/MT, reflecting continued tight domestic supplies and strong market demand from traders, grain processors and state marketing agencies. However, using the parallel exchange rate, the July price is estimated at USD 203/MT, making Malawi the lowest-priced maize market in the region despite the recent month-on-month increase.

By contrast, **Zambia** recorded a 12.7% decline, with prices falling from USD 307/MT to USD 268/MT, supported by improved market availability following main harvest inflows and seasonal replenishment of stocks. **Mozambique** also registered a modest 2.0% decrease, with prices easing from USD 456/MT to USD 447/MT, suggesting relatively stable supply conditions despite remaining one of the region's higher-priced maize markets.

**Table 10** summarises maize price trends across selected Southern African, showing mixed short-term trends but a generally declining pattern over the medium to long term. In **Malawi**, maize prices increased by 3.2% month-on-month to MWK 773.05/kg, suggesting localized supply pressures and continued market demand. However, prices remained significantly below levels recorded three months ago (-16.2%), six months ago (-33.0%), and one year ago (-31.3%), reflecting substantial market improvements compared to previous periods. In **Mozambique**, white maize prices declined by 1.9% during the month to MZN 28.26/kg. Despite the recent decline, prices remained 38.7% higher than three months ago and 83.5% above year-earlier levels, indicating that the market continues to experience the effects of earlier supply constraints and localized production shortfalls.

**Zambia** recorded the sharpest decline among the monitored countries, with maize prices falling by 9.9% month-on-month to ZMW 4.99/kg. Prices were also significantly lower than three months ago (-33.4%), six months ago (-31.6%), and one year earlier (-12.3%), reflecting improved national supplies following a strong harvest and increased market

[38] These price spreads are calculated based on online rates at: https://www.oanda.com/currency-converter/en

availability. However, the Food Reserve Agency's (FRA) announced purchase price of ZMW 347/50kg bag[39] (ZMW 6.94/kg) is substantially above prevailing market prices and may exert upward pressure on prices as public procurement progresses.

*Table 10: Percentage changes in maize prices in Southern Africa[40]*

| Country | Crop | Market | Last Price | 1 Month % | 3 Months % | 6 Months % | 1 Year % |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Malawi | Maize | National Average, MWK/Kg | 773.05 | 3.18 | -16.16 | -33.03 | -31.28 |
| Mozambique | Maize (white) | National Average, MZN/Kg | 28.26 | -1.91 | 38.69 | -25.95 | 83.49 |
| Zambia | Maize (white) | National Average, Retail, ZMW/KG | 4.99 | -9.90 | -33.42 | -31.60 | -12.32 |

**Note**: Latest price is for July 2026, * June 2026, and ** May 2026

= no change, = low increase (0-5%), = moderate increase (5-15%), = high increase (>15%), = low decrease (0-5%), = moderate decrease (5-15%), = high decrease (>15%)

## Rice

*Figure 11: National average price spreads for rice across select Southern African Countries*

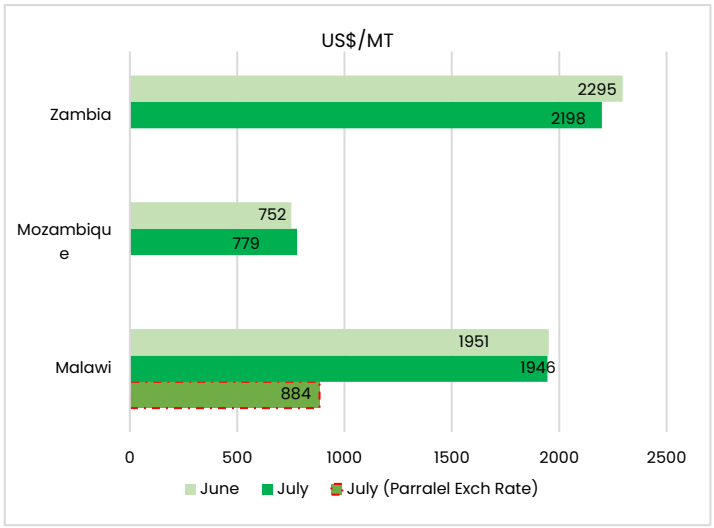



**Figure 11** illustrates rice price movements (in USD per metric tonne) across Zambia, Mozambique, and Malawi, showing generally stable to slightly declining prices between June and July. **Zambia** remained the highest-priced rice market, although prices eased by 4.2%, declining from USD 2,295/MT to USD 2,198/MT, reflecting improved market availability and reduced seasonal pressure. Similarly, **Malawi** recorded a marginal 0.3% decline, with prices falling from USD 1,951/MT to USD 1,946/MT (USD 884/MT at parallel rate) indicating relative market stability. In contrast, **Mozambique** was the only market to record an increase, with rice prices rising by 3.6% from USD 752/MT to USD 779/MT, reflecting tightening supplies, higher import costs, and localized demand pressures. However, Mozambique continues to maintain the lowest rice prices among the monitored countries.

As illustrated in **Table 11**, rice prices in local currency terms across selected Southern African, showing a generally declining trend over both the short and medium term, with the exception of imported rice in Mozambique, which recorded a modest monthly increase. In **Malawi**, rice prices declined marginally by 0.5% month-on-month to MWK 3,357.45/kg and remained significantly lower than three months ago (-15.5%), six months ago (-13.9%), and a year earlier (-18.4%). The sustained decline reflects improved market supplies and subdued domestic demand conditions.

In **Mozambique**, imported rice prices increased by 3.5% during the month to MZN 49.20/kg, although prices remained below levels recorded three months ago (-8.3%), six months ago (-24.9%), and one year ago (-15.4%). The monthly increase may reflect rising import and distribution costs, but overall market conditions remain more favorable than in previous periods. In **Zambia**, local rice prices declined by 1.1**%** month-on-month to ZMW 40.94/kg and were also lower than three months ago (-5.5%), six months ago (-1.1%), and a year earlier (-2.5%), indicating relatively stable supplies and moderate market conditions.

*Table 11: Percentage changes in rice prices in Southern Africa[41]*

| Country | Crop | Market | Last Price | 1 Month % | 3 Months % | 6 Months % | 1 Year % |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Malawi | Rice | National Average, MWK/Kg | 3,357.45 | -0.48 | -15.47 | -13.91 | -18.44 |
| Mozambique | Rice (imported) | National Average, MZN/Kg | 49.20 | 3.54 | -8.29 | -24.88 | -15.41 |
| Zambia | Rice (Local) | National Average, Retail, ZMW/KG | 40.94 | -1.13 | -5.54 | -1.11 | -2.52 |

**Note**: Latest price is for July 2026, * June 2026, and ** May 2026

= no change, = low increase (0-5%), = moderate increase (5-15%), = high increase (>15%), = low decrease (0-5%), = moderate decrease (5-15%), = high decrease (>15%)

[39] https://www.facebook.com/OfficialUPNDZambia/posts/fra-sets-2026-maize-buying-price-at-k347-per-50kg-bag-targets-500000-metric-tonn/1368726648777649/

[40] Author's construction based on AGRA MIS data for Malawi and Mozambique, and FAO data for Zambia and Zimbabwe

[41] Author's construction based on AGRA MIS data for Malawi and Mozambique, and FAO data for Zambia

## Beans

*Figure 12: National average price spreads for beans across select Southern African Countries*

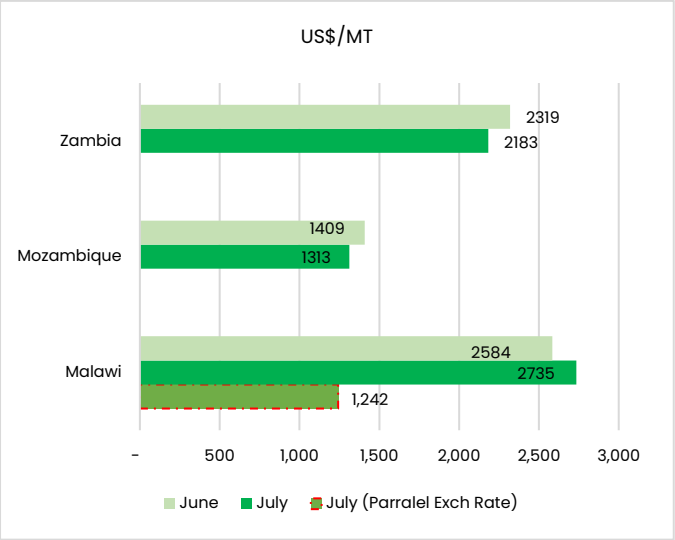



**Figure 12** illustrates national average bean price trends in USD for selected Southern African countries, showing mixed movements between June and July.

**Malawi** recorded the highest bean prices in the region, rising by 5.8% from USD 2,584/MT to USD 2,735/MT, reflecting continued supply tightness and strong consumer demand. However, when converted using the parallel exchange rate, the July price falls to approximately USD 1,242/MT, making Malawi the lowest-priced bean market among the monitored countries.

In contrast, **Zambia** posted a 5.9% decline, with prices falling from USD 2,319/MT to USD 2,183/MT, suggesting improved market availability following recent harvests and increased supplies. **Mozambique** also recorded a notable decline of 6.8%, with prices easing from USD 1,409/MT to USD 1,313/MT, reflecting enhanced domestic supplies and steady cross-border inflows.

**Table 12** presents bean and soybean prices in local currencies across selected Southern African countries, showing mixed short-term trends but generally lower prices compared to six months and one year ago. **Malawi** recorded the strongest monthly increases among the monitored markets, with bean prices rising by 5.6% to MWK 4,718.44/kg and soybean prices increasing by 5.8% to MWK 2,422.83/kg. Despite these gains, both commodities remained significantly below six-month levels, declining by 30.5% and 34.6%, respectively, while annual prices were lower by 25.3% for beans and 8.0% for soybeans. The recent increases likely reflect seasonal tightening of market supplies.

In **Mozambique**, bean prices declined by 6.8% month-on-month to MZN 82.97/kg, although they remained broadly stable over the medium term, increasing marginally by 0.2% over three months and 13.3% higher than a year earlier. This suggests that despite the recent decline, underlying market conditions remain relatively firm compared to last year. In **Zambia**, bean prices fell by 2.8% during the month to ZMW 40.65/kg, continuing a downward trend observed over the past three months (-15.8%) and six months (-11.1%). Overall, bean and soybean markets in Southern Africa appear well supplied, with sustained price declines over the medium term indicating improved production and market availability, although Malawi's recent price increases may signal emerging seasonal supply pressures.

*Table 12: Percentage changes in beans prices in Southern Africa*[42]

| Country | Crop | Market | Last Price | 1 Month % | 3 Months % | 6 Months % | 1 Year % |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Malawi | Beans | National Average, MWK/Kg | 4,718.44 | 5.59 ↑ | 2.04 ▲ | -30.50 ↓ | -25.30 ↓ |
| Malawi | Soyabeans | National Average, MWK/Kg | 2,422.83 | 5.77 ↑ | -4.35 ↘ | -34.56 ↓ | -7.99 ↓ |
| Mozambique | Beans | National Average, MZN/Kg | 82.97 | -6.84 ↓ | 0.20 ▲ | -3.87 ↘ | 13.28 ↑ |
| Zambia | Beans | National Average, Retail, ZMW/KG | 40.65 | -2.84 ↘ | -15.80 ↓ | -11.05 ↓ | |

**Note**: Latest price is for July 2026, * June 2026, and ** May 2026

● = no change, ▲ = low increase (0-5%), ↑ = moderate increase (5-15%), ⊗ = high increase (>15%),

↘ = low decrease (0-5%), ↓ = moderate decrease (5-15%), ↓ = high decrease (>15%)

## Seasonal Monitor and Cropping Conditions[43]

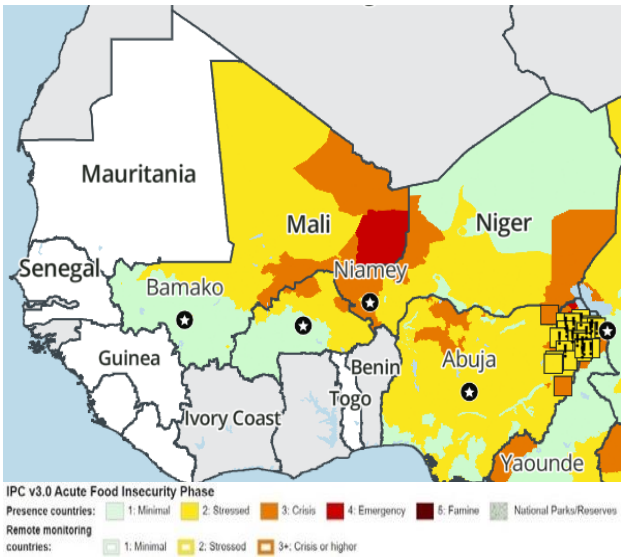
**Southern Africa** has completed harvesting of the 2025/26 main cereal season, with most areas now in the dry season and planting for the 2026/27 season expected to commence in September. While improved soil moisture and surface water reserves have supported water availability for irrigated crops, seasonal forecasts indicate an increased likelihood of El Niño-induced dry spells across parts of Angola, northern South Africa, and southern Mozambique. In Zambia, delayed and below-average rainfall is forecast for the October 2026 to May 2027 season, raising concerns over reduced planting opportunities, lower cropped area, and constrained agricultural labor demand.

[42] Author's construction based on AGRA MIS data for Malawi and Mozambique, and Zambia Statistics Agency data for Zambia

[43] Crop Monitor No. 117 – July 2026: https://www.cropmonitor.org/s/EarlyWarning_CropMonitor_202607-kdbf.pdf

## West Africa Food Security Update

*Figure 13: West African Countries Food Security Outlook, July 2026*




**Burkina Faso's** food security situation remains driven by a combination of insecurity, mixed agricultural prospects, and localized market pressures. Crisis (IPC Phase 3) outcomes are expected to persist in Soum Region (including Karo-Peli Province) through January 2027, as insecurity continues to limit livelihoods, forcing poor households to reduce food consumption despite subsidized cereal sales and humanitarian assistance that currently covers most food needs.[44] The 2026 agricultural season has been affected by a late and uneven onset of rainfall, delaying planting by 20 to 30 days in some areas and likely reducing cultivated area and yields, although regions with more favourable rainfall conditions are progressing normally.

Nationally, cereal prices have fallen significantly for a second consecutive year due to strong previous harvests, producer destocking, and government-subsidized grain sales, improving food availability. However, households in conflict-affected areas continue to face unusually high food prices due to constrained market supplies and elevated transport costs. At the same time, improved security conditions in some regions have expanded access to farmland, increased the participation of returnees in agricultural activities, and are expected to support better production prospects compared with recent years, provided favourable rainfall continues.

**Côte d'Ivoire's** food security situation is expected to remain Stressed (IPC Phase 2) in the northern regions through January 2027, driven by the continued influx of more than 80,000 refugees from Burkina Faso and Mali, which is increasing pressure on food, livelihoods, basic services, and natural resources.[45] Persistent cross-border insecurity is further constraining access to farmland and grazing areas, reducing agricultural and livestock production, limiting market supplies, and contributing to higher food prices that undermine poor households' food and income sources. Humanitarian assistance remains critical in refugee-hosting areas such as Tchologo, Bounkani, and Poro, although growing needs are straining available support. Meanwhile, floods in southern Côte d'Ivoire, particularly around Abidjan, have temporarily disrupted livelihoods, damaged crops and infrastructure, and increased local food prices, but overall food security outcomes in these areas are expected to remain Minimal (IPC Phase 1) despite localized hardship among affected households.

In **Mali**, food security situation remains severely affected by insecurity, market disruption, and agricultural challenges. Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes are expected to persist in Kidal and Ménaka due to conflict-related restrictions on movement, trade, and livelihoods, with Kidal likely remaining in Emergency through January 2027, while Ménaka is expected to improve to Crisis (IPC Phase 3) from October as crops become available.[46] In the insecure Liptako-Gourma areas, Crisis (IPC Phase 3) conditions are expected through September before improving to Stressed (IPC Phase 2) with green harvests. Ongoing attacks continue to disrupt markets, displace populations, and constrain economic activity, while below-average rainfall, poor access to agricultural inputs, and insecurity have delayed planting and reduced cultivated areas, threatening harvest prospects in some regions. Supply chain disruptions, high transport and fuel costs, and elevated food prices, particularly in Kidal and Ménaka, are further reducing food access for poor households. Meanwhile, humanitarian assistance remains insufficient due to severe funding shortfalls and limited access to insecure areas, leaving many vulnerable households with inadequate support.

**Niger's** food security outlook is characterized by persistent conflict-related hardship in affected regions and gradual improvement elsewhere. Crisis (IPC Phase 3) outcomes are expected to continue through January 2027 in Tillabéri, Diffa, and northwestern Tahoua due to insecurity, repeated agricultural losses, disrupted markets, reduced labour opportunities, and declining household purchasing power, with some displaced households facing Emergency (IPC Phase 4) conditions.[47] Food access remains particularly constrained in conflict-affected areas where staple food prices are well above the national average and market supplies are limited. Across most of the rest of the country, Stressed (IPC Phase 2) conditions are expected through September before improving to Minimal (IPC Phase 1) from

[44] https://fews.net/west-africa/burkina-faso
[45] https://fews.net/west-africa/cote-divoire
[46] https://fews.net/west-africa/mali
[47] https://fews.net/west-africa/niger

October as new harvests become available and pastoral conditions improve. However, the 2026 agropastoral season has started late, with below average and irregular rainfall delaying planting, reducing pasture and water availability, and weakening livestock conditions, especially in Diffa, Maradi, Zinder, and Agadez. Although security incidents have declined compared with 2025, ongoing violence continues to cause displacement and disrupt livelihoods and trade in the most affected regions.

In **Nigeria**, the food security situation remains highly pressured by conflict, high food prices, and declining household purchasing power. Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes persist in inaccessible areas of northeastern states, particularly in Abadam, Bama, Guzamala, and Marte LGAs, where intensified conflict restricts access to farmland, markets, and humanitarian assistance, leading to severe food consumption gaps.[48] Across much of northern Nigeria, Crisis (IPC Phase 3) conditions are expected to continue through January 2027 as insecurity disrupts livelihoods, market activity, and agricultural production, with attacks, levies, and cultivation restrictions limiting food production in key farming areas. At the same time, elevated staple food and fuel prices, despite broader macroeconomic improvements, are eroding purchasing power as poor households become increasingly dependent on market purchases during the lean season. Food insecurity is being further aggravated by worsening health conditions, including cholera outbreaks and other waterborne diseases, which increase healthcare costs, reduce labour availability, and further constrain poor households' ability to meet their food needs.

**Togo's** food security situation remains relatively stable in most areas, but conditions have worsened significantly in the far north, where Kpendjal and Kpendjal-West prefectures deteriorated to Crisis (IPC Phase 3) in July 2026 due to persistent insecurity and the threat of extremist incursions disrupting agricultural activities, trade, market access, and livelihoods.[49] Elsewhere in northern Togo, Stressed (IPC Phase 2) outcomes prevail as declining household incomes and depleting food stocks increase dependence on markets, although many households continue to meet their basic food needs through expanded income-generating activities such as petty trade, charcoal production, firewood sales, collection of forest products, and casual labour. Flooding in parts of Greater Lomé and the Maritime Region has caused localized disruptions to market access, food access, and essential services, particularly in vulnerable urban areas, though impacts on agricultural production have been limited. Market conditions remain generally favourable, supported by adequate food stocks and early harvests, with maize and sorghum prices substantially below both last year's levels and the five-year average. However, localized price increases for some commodities, such as cowpeas in Cinkassé, reflect reduced cross-border supplies. Overall, insecurity in the north remains the primary driver of food insecurity despite generally adequate national food availability and relatively stable market conditions.

## Commodity Prices

*Key drivers of the price movements in West Africa include.*

| | | |
|---|---|---|
|  | **Insecurity & Armed Conflicts** | Conflict, insecurity, and political tension in West Africa continue to disrupt agriculture, trade, and food assistance activities, resulting in higher food prices. |
|  | **Macroeconomic Challenges** | Poor macroeconomic conditions, driven by high inflation rates, local currency depreciations and elevated fuel prices are pushing food prices upwards in some West African countries. |
|  | **Seasonal Dynamics** | Seasonal changes in food supply, including the early onset of the lean season in most countries in West Africa, are putting upward pressure on food prices. |

[48] https://fews.net/west-africa/nigeria
[49] https://fews.net/west-africa/togo

## Maize

*Figure 14: Price spreads for maize across select West African Countries*[50]

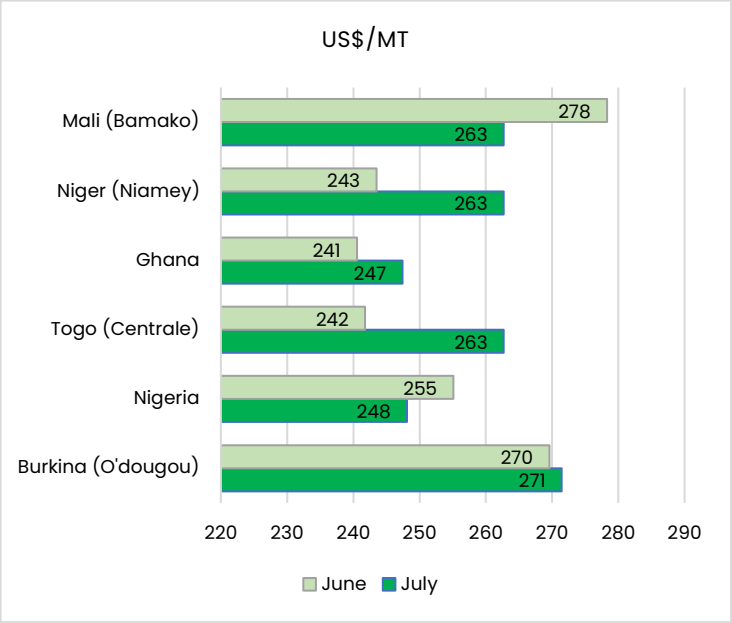



**Figure 14** illustrates maize price movements (USD/metric tonne) across selected West African market showing mixed movements between June and July. **Burkina Faso (Ouagadougou)** remained relatively stable, with prices increasing marginally by 0.4% from USD 270/MT to USD 271/MT, indicating stable market conditions. **Ghana** also recorded a modest increase of 2.5%, with prices rising from USD 241/MT to USD 247/MT, reflecting slight tightening in domestic supply.

The strongest increases were observed in **Niger (Niamey)** and **Togo (Centrale)**, where prices rose by 7.9% and 8.7%, respectively, from USD 243/MT to USD 263/MT and from USD 242/MT to USD 263/MT. These gains reflect increased demand and localized supply constraints in the lean season. In contrast, **Nigeria** recorded a 2.7% decline, with prices easing from USD 255/MT to USD 248/MT, suggesting improved market availability and continued inflows from surplus-producing areas. **Mali (Bamako)** registered the largest decline among the monitored markets, with prices falling by 5.4% from USD 278/MT to USD 263/MT, indicating improved supplies following harvest inflows and cross-border trade.

**Table 13** presents maize price trends in local currencies across select West African countriesshowing generally stable to mixed market conditions during the reporting period. In **Burkina Faso**, maize prices remained stable across all monitored markets during the month. However, divergent longer-term trends were observed, with prices declining by between 20% and 44% year-on-year, reflecting improved supplies and easing market pressures compared to last year. In **Ghana**, national average white maize prices increased by 6.3% month-on-month to GHS 2,883/MT, although prices remained significantly lower than three months ago (-5.2%), six months ago (-18.7%), and a year earlier (-50.1%), suggesting that improved domestic supplies continue to moderate market conditions despite the recent increase.
In **Mali**, maize prices exhibited mixed trends across markets. Strong monthly increases were recorded in Ségou (+16.7%), Kayes (+11.1%), and Gao (+10.0%), while prices declined in Bamako (-6.3%), Sikasso (-7.1%), and Tombouctou (-7.4%). Despite localized increases, most markets remained below year-earlier levels, indicating relatively favorable supply conditions.

In **Niger**, imported maize prices rose across all monitored markets, with particularly sharp increases observed in Dosso (+28.6%), Zinder (+12.9%), Maradi (+9.7%), and Agadez (+8.0%). Strong gains were also recorded over the three- and six-month periods in several markets, suggesting tightening supplies and growing dependence on imported grain. Nevertheless, prices remained 24% to 40% lower than a year ago, reflecting improved regional availability compared to the same period last year. In **Nigeria**, white maize prices declined by 4.1% month-on-month to NGN 337.71/kg, although prices remained 11.6% higher than three months ago and marginally above six-month levels. The annual decline of 22.5% suggests improved supplies relative to last year. In **Togo**, maize prices showed mixed movements across markets, with Centrale recording a 7.9% increase, while Maritime (-1.3%) and Savanes (-1.5%) experienced modest declines. Across all Togolese markets, prices remained substantially lower than a year earlier, with annual declines ranging from 26.9% to 41.8%.

[50] These price spreads are calculated based on online rates at https://www.oanda.com/currency-converter/en

*Table 13: Percentage changes in maize prices in West Africa*[51]

| Country | Crop | Market | Last Price | 1 Month % | 3 Months % | 6 Months % | 1 Year % |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Burkina Faso | Maize | Bobo Dioulasso, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 15,500.00 | 0.00 | 3.33 | 3.33 | -38.00 |
| Burkina Faso | Maize | Dédougou, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 17,500.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 2.94 | -30.00 |
| Burkina Faso | Maize | Dori, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 22,000.00 | 0.00 | -8.33 | -12.00 | -26.67 |
| Burkina Faso | Maize | Fada N'gourma, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 18,500.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | -28.85 |
| Burkina Faso | Maize | Kongoussi, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 20,000.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | -20.00 |
| Burkina Faso | Maize | Nouna, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 17,500.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | -12.50 | -30.00 |
| Burkina Faso | Maize | Ouagadougou, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 15,500.00 | 0.00 | -3.13 | -3.13 | -36.73 |
| Burkina Faso | Maize | Tenkodogo, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 15,000.00 | 0.00 | -3.23 | -6.25 | -44.44 |
| Ghana | Maize (white) | National Average, (GHS/MT) | 2,883.15 | 6.26 | -5.24 | -18.71 | -50.14 |
| Mali | Maize | Bamako, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 15,000.00 | -6.25 | -6.25 | -3.23 | -28.57 |
| Mali | Maize | Gao, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 27,500.00 | 10.00 | 0.00 | -8.33 | -8.33 |
| Mali | Maize | Kayes, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 20,000.00 | 11.11 | 11.11 | 11.11 | -13.04 |
| Mali | Maize | Mopti, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 19,000.00 | 0.00 | -5.00 | 11.76 | -20.83 |
| Mali | Maize | Ségou, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 17,500.00 | 16.67 | 16.67 | 16.67 | -7.89 |
| Mali | Maize | Sikasso, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 13,000.00 | -7.14 | -7.14 | -3.70 | -35.00 |
| Mali | Maize | Tombouctou, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 25,000.00 | -7.41 | -7.41 | 4.17 | -28.57 |
| Niger | Maize (imported) | Agadez, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 27,000.00 | 8.00 | -3.57 | -10.00 | -30.23 |
| Niger | Maize (imported) | Dosso, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 18,000.00 | 28.57 | 33.33 | -2.70 | -33.33 |
| Niger | Maize (imported) | Maradi, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 17,000.00 | 9.68 | 30.77 | 41.67 | -26.09 |
| Niger | Maize (imported) | Niamey, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 15,000.00 | 7.14 | -1.56 | -11.76 | -40.00 |
| Niger | Maize (imported) | Tillaberi, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 19,000.00 | 5.56 | 5.56 | 0.00 | -30.91 |
| Niger | Maize (imported) | Zinder, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 17,500.00 | 12.90 | 16.67 | 25.00 | -23.91 |
| Nigeria | Maize (white) | National Average, NGN/KG | 337.71 | -4.08 | 11.55 | 2.56 | -22.47 |
| Togo | Maize (white), XOF/Kg | Centrale,Retail, XOF/Kg* | 150.00 | 7.91 | -7.41 | -17.58 | -33.33 |
| Togo | Maize (white), XOF/Kg | DAGL (Lomé) Region, Retail, XOF/Kg* | 198.00 | 2.59 | -1.00 | -12.78 | -26.94 |
| Togo | Maize (white), XOF/Kg | Maritime,Retail, XOF/Kg* | 154.00 | -1.28 | -6.67 | -9.41 | -33.04 |
| Togo | Maize (white), XOF/Kg | Savanes,Retail, XOF/Kg* | 128.00 | -1.54 | -14.67 | -16.88 | -41.82 |

**Note**: Latest price is for July 2026, * June 2026, and ** May 2026

= no change, = low increase (0-5%), = moderate increase (5-15%), = high increase (>15%), = low decrease (0-5%), = moderate decrease (5-15%), = high decrease (>15%)

## Rice

*Figure 15: Price spreads for rice across select West African Countries*[52]

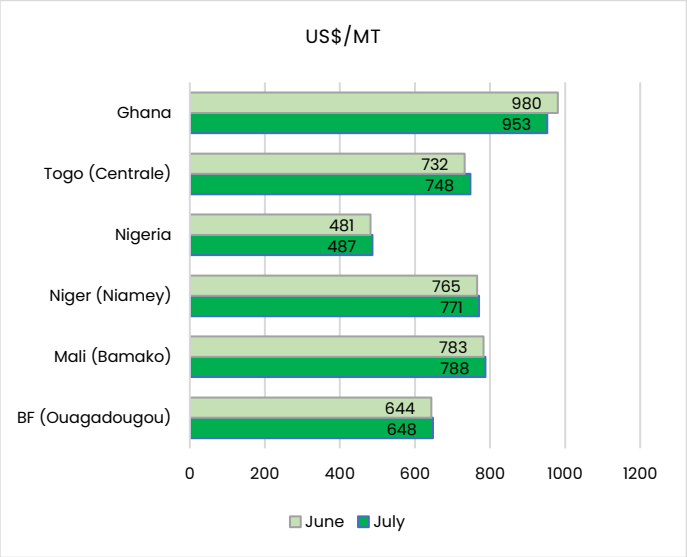



**Figure 15** illustrates rice price movements (USD/metric tonne) across selected West African markets, showing broadly stable conditions between June and July, with modest increases in most countries. **Ghana** remained the highest-priced rice market despite recording a 2.8% decline, with prices falling from USD 980/MT to USD 953/MT, reflecting improved market supplies.

Elsewhere, rice prices edged upward across the region. **Togo (Centrale)** recorded the largest increase of 2.2%, rising from USD 732/MT to USD 748/MT, suggesting growing demand and tighter local market availability. **Niger (Niamey)** posted a 1.6% increase, with prices rising from USD 765/MT to USD 777/MT, while **Nigeria** recorded a modest 1.2% increase, from USD 481/MT to USD 487/MT, maintaining its position as the lowest-priced market among those monitored. Similarly, **Mali (Bamako)** and **Burkina Faso (Ouagadougou)** experienced marginal increases of 0.6%, with prices rising from USD 783/MT to USD 788/MT and USD 644/MT to USD 648/MT, respectively, indicating relatively stable market conditions.

**Table 14** shows that rice prices, expressed in local currencies, were generally stable across the monitored markets,

[51] Author's construction based on 1) AGRA MIS for Ghana & Nigeria; and 2) FAO data for Togo

[52] These price spreads are calculated based on online rates on the last day of the month at https://www.oanda.com/currency-converter/en

indicating relatively balanced supply and demand conditions. In **Burkina Faso**, imported rice prices remained largely unchanged across all monitored markets during the month. However, medium- and long-term trends varied. While prices in Dori and Ouagadougou were higher than three and six months ago, most markets recorded year-on-year declines ranging from 9.8% to 27.3%, indicating generally improved market availability. **Ghana** recorded a marginal monthly increase of 0.4%, with prices reaching GHS 11,100/MT. Despite this increase, prices remained 11.9% below six-month levels and 25.1% lower than a year earlier, reflecting improved domestic and imported rice supplies.

In **Mali**, price trends differed between local and imported rice. Local rice prices remained stable in Bamako, Kayes, and Ségou, while modest increases were recorded in Mopti (+2.5%) and Sikasso (+2.5%). Imported rice prices were generally stable, although Sikasso recorded a notable 5.3% monthly increase. On an annual basis, most imported rice markets recorded declines of between 4.8% and 29.2%, suggesting improved supply conditions compared to last year. In **Niger**, imported rice prices increased across several markets, with Agadez, Dosso, and Tillaberi each recording monthly increases of approximately 4.5%. Despite these gains, prices remained lower than a year earlier across all monitored markets, with declines ranging from 4.2% to 12.5%.

In **Nigeria**, milled rice prices declined marginally by 0.3% to NGN 662.38/kg. However, prices remained 8.3% higher than three months ago, indicating some recent upward pressure despite remaining 33.8% below year-earlier levels. In **Togo**, imported rice prices exhibited mixed movements. Prices increased in Centrale (+1.4%) and Maritime (+1.1%), while declining in DAGL/Lomé (-6.5%) and Savanes (-2.1%). Longer-term trends remained generally downward, with most markets recording annual declines, although Maritime was an exception, posting a 17.2% year-on-year increase.

*Table 14: Percentage changes in rice prices in West Africa*[53]

| Country | Crop | Market | Last Price | 1 Month % | 3 Months % | 6 Months % | 1 Year % |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Burkina Faso | Rice (imported) | Bobo Dioulasso, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 32,500.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | -23.53 | -23.53 |
| Burkina Faso | Rice (imported) | Dédougou, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 39,000.00 | 0.00 | -2.50 | -8.24 | -22.00 |
| Burkina Faso | Rice (imported) | Dori, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 44,000.00 | 0.00 | 10.00 | 4.76 | -21.43 |
| Burkina Faso | Rice (imported) | Fada N'gourma, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 38,000.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | -15.56 | -24.00 |
| Burkina Faso | Rice (imported) | Kongoussi, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 40,000.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | -20.00 | -27.27 |
| Burkina Faso | Rice (imported) | Nouna, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 55,000.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 |
| Burkina Faso | Rice (imported) | Ouagadougou, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 37,000.00 | 0.00 | 4.23 | 4.23 | -9.76 |
| Ghana | Rice | National Average, (GHS/MT) | 11,100.00 | 0.39 | 2.78 | -11.90 | -25.08 |
| Mali | Rice | Bamako, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 45,000.00 | 0.00 | 5.88 | 0.00 | 0.00 |
| Mali | Rice | Kayes, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 52,000.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 |
| Mali | Rice | Mopti, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 41,000.00 | 2.50 | -3.53 | -16.33 | -16.33 |
| Mali | Rice | Ségou, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 40,000.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | -5.88 |
| Mali | Rice | Sikasso, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 41,000.00 | 2.50 | 2.50 | 9.33 | -8.89 |
| Mali | Rice (imported) | Bamako, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 34,000.00 | 0.00 | -8.11 | -12.82 | -29.17 |
| Mali | Rice (imported) | Kayes, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 29,500.00 | 0.00 | -1.67 | -3.28 | -10.61 |
| Mali | Rice (imported) | Mopti, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 39,000.00 | 0.00 | -4.88 | -13.33 | -22.00 |
| Mali | Rice (imported) | Ségou, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 40,000.00 | 0.00 | -5.88 | -5.88 | -4.76 |
| Mali | Rice (imported) | Sikasso, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 40,000.00 | 5.26 | 2.56 | -4.76 | -16.67 |
| Niger | Rice (imported) | Agadez, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 48,000.00 | 4.35 | 4.35 | 4.35 | -7.69 |
| Niger | Rice (imported) | Dosso, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 46,000.00 | 4.55 | 4.55 | 4.55 | -4.17 |
| Niger | Rice (imported) | Maradi, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 42,000.00 | 0.00 | -4.55 | 0.00 | -12.50 |
| Niger | Rice (imported) | Niamey, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 44,000.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 4.76 | -12.00 |
| Niger | Rice (imported) | Tillaberi, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 46,000.00 | 4.55 | 0.00 | 4.55 | -11.54 |
| Nigeria | Rice (milled) | National Average, NGN/KG | 662.38 | -0.25 | 8.30 | -1.21 | -33.76 |
| Togo | Rice (imported) | Centrale,Retail, XOF/Kg* | 427.00 | 1.43 | -4.69 | -5.53 | -17.57 |
| Togo | Rice (imported) | DAGL (Lomé) Region, Retail, XOF/Kg* | 614.00 | -6.54 | -0.81 | -6.12 | -8.49 |
| Togo | Rice (imported) | Maritime,Retail, XOF/Kg* | 553.00 | 1.10 | -9.49 | 6.76 | 17.16 |
| Togo | Rice (imported) | Savanes,Retail, XOF/Kg* | 431.00 | -2.05 | -2.05 | -5.69 | -9.26 |

**Note**: Latest price is for July 2026, * June 2026, and ** May 2026

= no change, = low increase (0-5%), = moderate increase (5-15%), = high increase (>15%),

= low decrease (0-5%), = moderate decrease (5-15%), = high decrease (>15%)

[53] Author's construction based on 1) AGRA MIS for Ghana & Nigeria; and 2) FAO data for Burkina Faso, Mali, Niger, and Togo

## Millet

*Figure 16: Price spreads for millet across select West African Countries*[54]

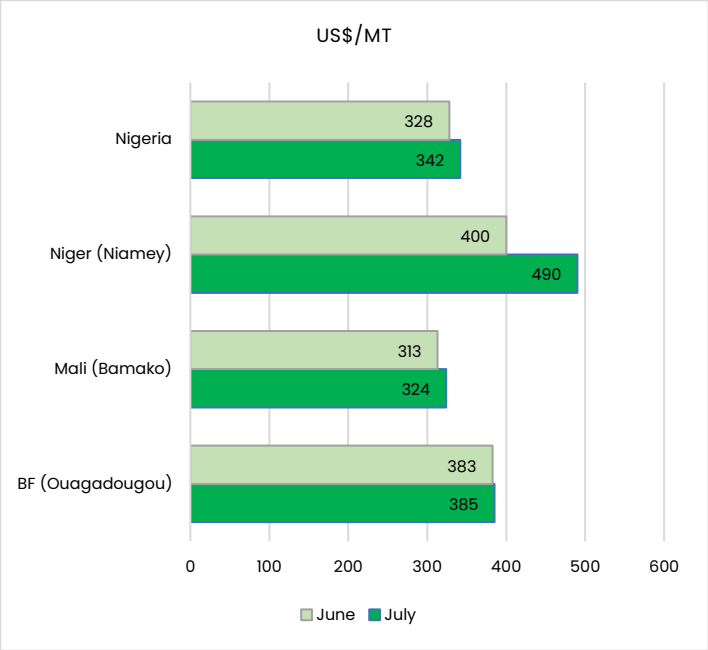



**Figure 16** illustrates millet price movements (in USD per metric tonne) across selected West African markets, showing broad-based increases between June and July. The largest month-on-month increase was recorded in Niger (Niamey), where prices surged by 22.5%, rising from USD 400/MT to USD 490/MT, reflecting tightening supplies, strong regional demand, and seasonal stock drawdowns.
More moderate increases were observed in the remaining markets.

**Nigeria** recorded a 4.3% increase, with prices rising from USD 328/MT to USD 342/MT, while **Mali (Bamako)** posted a 3.5% increase, from USD 313/MT to USD 324/MT, indicating firmer market conditions despite ongoing harvest inflows. **Burkina Faso (Ouagadougou)** remained relatively stable, with prices increasing marginally by 0.5% from USD 383/MT to USD 385/MT, suggesting balanced supply and demand conditions.

**Table 15** shows that millet prices, expressed in local currencies, in most markets continued to record prices below year-earlier levels, indicating improved availability compared to the same period last year. In **Burkina Faso**, millet prices remained unchanged across all monitored markets during the month. However, medium-term trends varied, with prices declining in most markets over the past three and six months, while Fada N'Gourma recorded increases of 3.7% and 12.0%, respectively. On an annual basis, prices were significantly lower across all markets, with declines ranging from 4.0% to 30.0%, reflecting improved domestic supplies and generally favorable market conditions.

In **Mali**, millet prices exhibited mixed but generally positive month-on-month trends. Significant increases were recorded in Mopti (+9.1%), Kayes (+7.7%), and Ségou (+7.1%), while Bamako posted a modest 2.8% increase. In contrast, Sikasso recorded a sharp decline of 13.0%. Over longer periods, Kayes remained one of the strongest performing markets, with prices increasing by 7.7% over three months and 3.7% over six months, whereas most other markets remained below levels observed a year earlier. These developments suggest localized tightening in supplies in parts of central and western Mali.

The strongest price increases were observed in **Niger**, where millet prices rose across all monitored markets during the month. Notable increases were recorded in Niamey (+21.7%), Dosso (+18.2%), Agadez (+12.0%), and Tillaberi (+12.0%). These increases were accompanied by substantial gains over the three- and six-month periods, particularly in Dosso (+26.8% and +30.0%), Maradi (+15.8% and +51.7%), and Niamey (+21.7% and +33.3%), indicating significant tightening of market supplies and growing upward pressure on millet prices. Nevertheless, annual prices remained below year-earlier levels in most markets, except for Niamey, where prices were unchanged.

In **Nigeria**, millet prices increased by 2.8% month-on-month to NGN 465.27/kg and were 13.7% higher than three months ago and 36.2% above six-month levels, pointing to stronger domestic demand and tighter market supplies. However, prices remained 13.6% lower than a year ago, reflecting improved conditions relative to the previous season.

[54] These price spreads are calculated based on online rates at https://www.oanda.com/currency-converter/en

*Table 15: Percentage changes in millet prices in select West African Countries*[55]

| Country | Crop | Market | Last Price | 1 Month % | 3 Months % | 6 Months % | 1 Year % |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Burkina Faso | Millet | Bobo Dioulasso, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 36,500.00 | 0.00 | -2.67 | -3.95 | -3.95 |
| Burkina Faso | Millet | Dédougou, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 21,000.00 | 0.00 | -2.33 | 0.00 | -30.00 |
| Burkina Faso | Millet | Dori, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 29,000.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | -3.33 | -23.68 |
| Burkina Faso | Millet | Fada N'gourma, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 28,000.00 | 0.00 | 3.70 | 12.00 | -12.50 |
| Burkina Faso | Millet | Kongoussi, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 30,000.00 | 0.00 | -6.25 | -7.69 | -29.41 |
| Burkina Faso | Millet | Nouna, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 22,500.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | -25.00 |
| Burkina Faso | Millet | Ouagadougou, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 22,000.00 | 0.00 | -6.38 | -2.22 | -26.67 |
| Mali | Millet | Bamako, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 18,500.00 | 2.78 | -2.63 | -15.91 | -22.92 |
| Mali | Millet | Kayes, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 28,000.00 | 7.69 | 7.69 | 3.70 | 0.00 |
| Mali | Millet | Mopti, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 24,000.00 | 9.09 | 0.00 | 4.35 | -14.29 |
| Mali | Millet | Ségou, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 15,000.00 | 7.14 | 0.00 | -9.09 | -25.00 |
| Mali | Millet | Sikasso, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 20,000.00 | -13.04 | -13.04 | -11.11 | -20.00 |
| Niger | Millet | Agadez, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 28,000.00 | 12.00 | 0.00 | -9.09 | -23.91 |
| Niger | Millet | Dosso, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 26,000.00 | 18.18 | 26.83 | 30.00 | -5.45 |
| Niger | Millet | Maradi, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 22,000.00 | 2.33 | 15.79 | 51.72 | -12.00 |
| Niger | Millet | Niamey, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 28,000.00 | 21.74 | 21.74 | 33.33 | 0.00 |
| Niger | Millet | Tillaberi, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 28,000.00 | 12.00 | 16.67 | 21.74 | -6.67 |
| Nigeria | Millet | National Average, NGN/KG | 465.27 | 2.82 | 13.74 | 36.24 | -13.55 |

**Note**: Latest price is for July 2026, * June 2026, and ** May 2026

= no change, = low increase (0-5%), = moderate increase (5-15%), = high increase (>15%),

= low decrease (0-5%), = moderate decrease (5-15%), = high decrease (>15%)

## Sorghum

*Figure 17: Price spreads for sorghum across select West African Countries*[56]

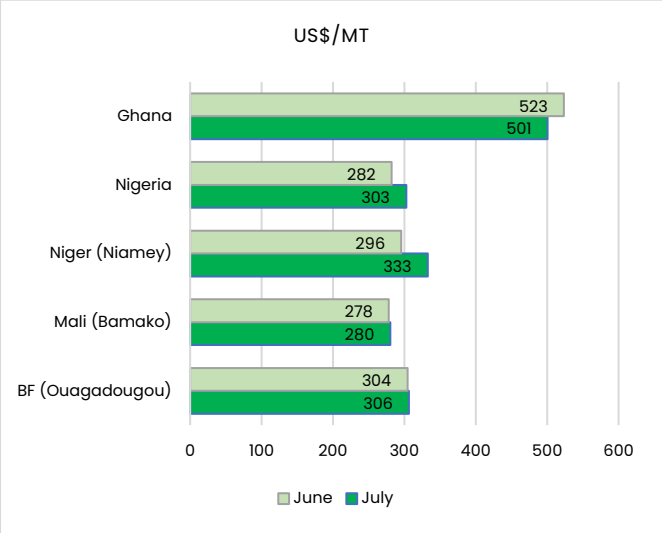



**Figure 17** presents sorghum prices (in USD per metric tonne) across selected West African markets, showing broadly higher prices between June and July, with increases in all monitored countries except Ghana. **Niger (Niamey)** recorded the most significant rise, with prices increasing by 12.5% from USD 296/MT to USD 333/MT, reflecting tightening supplies, seasonal stock depletion, and strong regional demand. **Nigeria** also posted a notable increase of 7.4%, with prices rising from USD 282/MT to USD 303/MT, indicating firmer market conditions and reduced market availability.

More moderate increases were observed in **Burkina Faso (Ouagadougou)** and **Mali (Bamako)**, where maize prices rose by 0.7% in both markets, suggesting relative stable market conditions supported by adequate supplies and limited pressure on domestic markets. In Ouagadougou, prices increased from USD 304/MT to USD 306/MT, while in Bamako prices edged up from USD 278/MT to USD 280/MT. The marginal changes suggest relatively stable market conditions. In contrast, **Ghana** was the only market to experience a decline, with sorghum prices falling by 4.2% from USD 523/MT to USD 501/MT. Despite this reduction, Ghana remained the highest-priced sorghum market among the countries monitored, reflecting relatively stronger domestic demand and higher market prices compared to neighbouring countries.

**Table 16** illustrates sorghum prices across selected West African markets, showing generally stable market conditions. In **Burkina Faso**, sorghum prices remained unchanged across all monitored markets during the month, reflecting stable supply conditions. Over the medium term, prices generally declined, particularly in Dédougou (-8.6%), Kongoussi (-4.8%), and Ouagadougou (-2.8%), while annual prices were substantially lower across all markets, with declines ranging from 4.4% to 36.0%. This suggests improved domestic availability and relatively stable market

[55] Author's construction based on 1) AGRA MIS for Ghana & Nigeria; and 2) FAO data for Burkina Faso, Mali, Niger, and Togo

[56] These price spreads are calculated based on online rates at https://www.oanda.com/currency-converter/en

conditions compared to last year. In **Ghana**, sorghum prices remained unchanged during the month at GHS 5,833/MT. However, prices were 2.8% lower than three months ago and 12.5% below six-month levels, although they remained marginally higher (1.6%) than a year earlier.

In **Mali**, sorghum prices exhibited mixed trends. Significant monthly increases were recorded in Kayes (+11.1%) and Ségou (+7.1%), while prices remained unchanged in Bamako and Mopti and declined modestly in Sikasso (-2.8%). Over the three-month period, Kayes and Ségou continued to record gains, indicating some localized supply tightening. Nevertheless, year-on-year prices remained lower across all markets, declining by between 13.0% and 25.0%, suggesting overall market conditions remain more favorable than last year.

The strongest increases were observed in **Niger**, where sorghum prices rose across all monitored markets. Notable monthly increases were recorded in Maradi (+21.9%), Niamey (+11.8%), Agadez (+8.0%), and Tillaberi (+7.3%). These increases were accompanied by substantial gains over the three- and six-month periods, particularly in Maradi (+50.0% and +50.0%), Niamey (+18.8% and +15.2%), and Tillaberi (+10.0% and +15.8%), pointing to tightening supplies and growing market pressure. Despite these recent increases, prices remained 24.0% to 32.5% lower than a year earlier, reflecting improved conditions relative to the previous season.

In **Nigeria**, white sorghum prices increased by 5.8% month-on-month to NGN 412.01/kg and were 16.4% higher than three months ago and 56.8% above six-month levels, indicating rising demand and tightening market availability. However, prices remained 9.2% lower than a year earlier, suggesting that current market conditions are still more favorable compared to the same period last year.

*Table 16: Percentage changes in sorghum prices in select West African countries* [57]

| Country | Crop | Market | Last Price | 1 Month % | 3 Months % | 6 Months % | 1 Year % |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Burkina Faso | Sorghum | Bobo Dioulasso, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 21,500.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | -4.44 | -4.44 |
| Burkina Faso | Sorghum | Dédougou, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 16,000.00 | 0.00 | -8.57 | -3.03 | -36.00 |
| Burkina Faso | Sorghum | Dori, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 24,000.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | -4.00 | -27.27 |
| Burkina Faso | Sorghum | Fada N'gourma, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 18,500.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | -28.85 |
| Burkina Faso | Sorghum | Kongoussi, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 20,000.00 | 0.00 | -4.76 | -11.11 | -20.00 |
| Burkina Faso | Sorghum | Nouna, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 20,000.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | -20.00 |
| Burkina Faso | Sorghum | Ouagadougou, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 17,500.00 | 0.00 | -2.78 | 0.00 | -27.08 |
| Ghana | Sorghum | National Average, (GHS/MT) | 5,833.33 | 0.00 | -2.78 | -12.50 | 1.58 |
| Mali | Sorghum | Bamako, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 16,000.00 | 0.00 | 10.34 | 3.23 | -23.81 |
| Mali | Sorghum | Kayes, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 20,000.00 | 11.11 | 11.11 | 5.26 | -20.00 |
| Mali | Sorghum | Mopti, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 20,000.00 | 0.00 | 0.00 | 5.26 | -13.04 |
| Mali | Sorghum | Ségou, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 15,000.00 | 7.14 | 7.14 | 0.00 | -25.00 |
| Mali | Sorghum | Sikasso, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 17,500.00 | -2.78 | -2.78 | -12.50 | -12.50 |
| Niger | Sorghum | Agadez, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 27,000.00 | 8.00 | 3.85 | -3.57 | -32.50 |
| Niger | Sorghum | Dosso, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 19,000.00 | 2.70 | 8.57 | -5.00 | -24.00 |
| Niger | Sorghum | Maradi, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 19,500.00 | 21.88 | 50.00 | 50.00 | -30.36 |
| Niger | Sorghum | Niamey, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 19,000.00 | 11.76 | 18.75 | 15.15 | -24.00 |
| Niger | Sorghum | Tillaberi, Wholesale, XOF/100 kg | 22,000.00 | 7.32 | 10.00 | 15.79 | -25.42 |
| Nigeria | Sorghum (white) | National Average, NGN/KG | 412.01 | 5.76 | 16.43 | 56.76 | -9.22 |

**Note**: Latest price is for July 2026, * June 2026, and ** May 2026

= no change, = low increase (0-5%), = moderate increase (5-15%), = high increase (>15%),

= low decrease (0-5%), = moderate decrease (5-15%), = high decrease (>15%)

## Seasonal Monitor and Cropping Conditions[58]

**West Africa** is generally experiencing favorable conditions for the 2026/27 main agricultural season. Harvesting of main-season cereals is underway in the Gulf of Guinea countries, while planting and crop development activities continue across the Sahel. Overall, agro-climatic conditions remain supportive, although localized challenges persist, including below-average rainfall in some northern areas and excessive moisture conditions in parts of the south. Despite the generally positive production outlook, conflict-affected areas continue to face disruptions to agricultural activities. In addition, rising fuel and fertilizer prices are increasing production costs, which could reduce input use and adversely affect crop yields during the 2026/27 season.

[57] Author's construction based on 1) AGRA MIS for Ghana & Nigeria; and 2) FAO data for Burkina Faso, Mali, Niger, and Togo

[58] Crop Monitor No. 116 – June 2026: https://www.cropmonitor.org/s/EarlyWarning_CropMonitor_202606-x95c.pdf

# Food Trade Updates

## East and Southern Africa Region Food Trade Updates

**Figure 18** provides an overview of the trade-related interventions and investments in July 2026 across various countries in East and Southern Africa over the past month and that are affecting the food trade in the region.

*Figure 18: East and Southern Africa cross-border trade updates, July 2026*



**Malawi and Zimbabwe**

Afreximbank's Africa Trade and Distribution Company Limited (ATDC) has launched national trade and distribution platforms in Zimbabwe and Malawi through joint ventures with CBZ Agro Yield and Press Corporation Plc, respectively, to strengthen value chains, improve logistics, facilitate trade finance, and expand intra-African trade. The new platforms aim to support commodity aggregation, warehousing, exports, market access, and SME development, while addressing market fragmentation and advancing the implementation of the African Continental Free Trade Area (AfCFTA) as part of ATDC's broader African industrialisation strategy.

**Figure 19** provides an overview of the trade-related interventions and investments in July 2026 across various countries in West Africa over the past month and that are affecting the food trade in the region.

*Figure 19: West Africa cross-border trade updates, July 2026*



**Nigeria**

The Nigeria Customs Service has launched a pilot Management Information System (MIS) and Electronic Cargo Tracking System (ECTS) at the PTML Area Command in Lagos to modernize customs operations, improve cargo monitoring, streamline trade processes, enhance transparency, and accelerate efficient, technology-driven border management.

**Burkina Faso**

Burkina Faso has lifted its four-year ban on millet, maize, and sorghum flour exports, allowing processors to access foreign markets again while requiring special export permits to monitor export volumes and safeguard domestic food supplies. The policy change follows a 53% increase in national cereal production between 2021/22 and 2025/26 and is expected to support local processing industries, expand market opportunities, and balance food security with economic growth.




**The digital Regional Food Balance Sheet provides near real-time estimates and projections for core staple crop production, stock levels, and other information in East and Southern Africa.**

For more information,
please visit **www.rfbsa.com**.

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**For more information contact:**

**Inclusive Markets, Trade, and Finance Division Email:**
Foodtrade@agra.org

**AGRA**

**West End Towers, 4th Floor;**
**Kanjata Road, Muthangari Drive, Off Waiyaki Way**
**P.O Box 66773**
**Westlands 00800, Nairobi**



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